

SS1 ENGLISH STUDIES LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1

TOPIC:

Spoken English: Oral Composition Skills I (Narrative)

Vocabulary Development: Vocabulary Associated with the Home

Grammar: Nouns – Number

A. SPOKEN ENGLISH: ORAL COMPOSITION SKILLS I (NARRATIVE)

Meaning of Oral Composition

Oral composition is the act of speaking to express thoughts, feelings, and experiences in an organized and fluent manner. It involves constructing sentences and paragraphs in speech form — that is, **speaking in a logical order** to make meaning clear to the listener.

Meaning of Narrative Composition

A **narrative composition** is a story or account of events, either real or imagined. It tells *what happened, how it happened, when, and to whom*. Narratives can be **personal experiences, folk tales, legends, or imaginary stories**.

Features of a Good Narrative

1. **Title:** Reflects the main idea of the story.
Example: “The Day I Got Lost,” “My First Day in Boarding School.”
2. **Introduction:** Introduces the setting and main characters.
3. **Body:** Describes the sequence of events in clear order.
4. **Climax:** The most exciting or important part of the story.

5. **Conclusion:** The end of the story, showing what was learned.

Language Features of Narratives

- Use of **past tense verbs**: *went, saw, heard, felt, ran.*
- Use of **connectors** for sequencing: *first, then, later, afterwards, suddenly, finally.*
- Use of **descriptive words**: *beautiful, noisy, frightened, bright, terrible.*
- Use of **direct speech** to make it lively:
“Stop!” my mother shouted.

Illustration / Example

Topic: *A Day I Will Never Forget*

One sunny afternoon, I was sent by my mother to buy some bread from the market. On my way, I met my best friend, Bassey. We decided to play football before going home. When I returned, my mother was very angry because the bread was already cold and she had waited for me for more than one hour. That day, I learned that obedience is better than fun.

Sample Classroom Activity

Show a **picture chart** of children playing football.

- Ask each student to describe what they see in complete sentences.
- Guide them to arrange their ideas in order: beginning → middle → end.
- Allow pairs or groups to share their stories orally before the class.

Evaluation (Oral Composition)

1. What is oral composition?
2. Mention four features of a good narrative.
3. Identify three connectors commonly used in storytelling.
4. Give two differences between written and oral composition.
5. Narrate briefly *“The Day I Got Injured.”*

Assignment (Oral Composition)

1. Write an outline of a short story titled "*The Stranger at Night.*"
2. Prepare a one-minute oral narration on "*A Visit to the Market.*"
3. Record your voice narrating "*How I Celebrated My Last Birthday*" and note three mistakes you made in pronunciation or grammar.



B. VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT: VOCABULARY ASSOCIATED WITH THE HOME

Meaning of Vocabulary

Vocabulary refers to the set of words known and used in a particular language or topic area. Having a wide vocabulary helps you express ideas clearly and understand others better.

Meaning of “Home” Vocabulary

These are words that name **rooms**, **furniture**, **utensils**, and **objects** found in and around the house.

1. Vocabulary Associated with the Kitchen

Item	Meaning/Use
Pot	Used for cooking food
Kettle	Used for boiling water
Ladle	Used for serving soup or stew
Spoon	Used for stirring or eating
Frying pan	Used for frying eggs, meat, etc.
Blender	Used to grind or mix ingredients
Cup	Used for drinking beverages
Sieve	Used to strain or separate particles

Example Sentences:

- My mother used a **ladle** to serve the soup.
- The **blender** was used to mix pepper and tomatoes.

2. Vocabulary Associated with the Dining Room

Item	Meaning/Use
Table	Furniture on which food is served
Chair	Furniture for sitting
Napkin	Used to wipe the mouth and hands
Cutlery	Knives, forks, and spoons used for eating
Jug	Used to serve water or drinks

Example Sentences:

- There are six **chairs** around the dining **table**.
- Mother placed clean **cutlery** before serving the meal.

3. Vocabulary Associated with the Living Room

Item	Meaning/Use
Sofa	Comfortable seat for two or more people
Carpet	Material covering the floor
Curtain	Used to cover windows
Television	Used for watching programs
Cushion	Soft pad used for comfort or decoration

Example Sentences:

- The **sofa** in our sitting room is made of leather.
- I helped my father clean the **carpet** and draw the **curtains**.

4. Vocabulary Associated with the Bedroom

Item	Meaning/Use
Bed	Furniture used for sleeping

Pillow	Soft support for the head while sleeping
Wardrobe	Used to keep clothes
Hanger	Used to hang clothes
Mirror	Used to see oneself

Example Sentences:

- My clothes are neatly arranged in the **wardrobe**.
- The **mirror** in my room is made of glass.

5. Vocabulary Associated with the Bathroom and Toilet

Item	Meaning/Use
Bucket	Used for fetching and storing water
Towel	Used for drying the body
Sponge	Used for washing the body
Soap	Used for cleaning
Tap	Device that controls the flow of water

Example Sentences:

- The **bucket** is filled with clean water.
- She hung her **towel** behind the door.

6. Vocabulary Associated with the Pantry or Store

Item	Meaning/Use
Shelf	Used to arrange food items
Jar	Used to keep food ingredients
Basket	Used to store fruits or vegetables

Container	Used to preserve food items
Bag of rice	Food storage bag

Example Sentences:

- We arranged the canned food on the **shelf**.
- Sugar and flour are kept in **jars** in the pantry.

Illustration / Activity

Draw a simple outline of a house. Label different rooms (kitchen, dining room, bedroom, living room, bathroom) and list five items found in each.

Evaluation (Vocabulary Development)

1. Define vocabulary.
2. List five items found in the kitchen and their uses.
3. Mention four things found in the living room.
4. Construct sentences with these words: *wardrobe, upholstery, cutlery*.
5. What is a pantry?

Assignment (Vocabulary Development)

1. Create a table showing five rooms in your house and five items found in each.
2. Write ten sentences using vocabulary associated with the home.
3. Match each household item with its use in your exercise book.

C. GRAMMAR: NOUNS – NUMBER

Meaning of Nouns

A **noun** is the name of a person, animal, place, thing, or idea.

Examples: girl, book, Lagos, dog, honesty.

Meaning of Number in Nouns

“Number” in grammar shows **whether we are referring to one (singular) or more than one (plural) item.**

- **Singular Noun:** Refers to one item. *Example:* boy, table, apple.
- **Plural Noun:** Refers to more than one item. *Example:* boys, tables, apples.

Rules for Forming Plural Nouns

Rule	Example (Singular → Plural)
1. Add -s to most nouns	book → books, car → cars
2. Add -es to nouns ending in s, x, z, ch, sh	box → boxes, bush → bushes
3. Change y to ies when a consonant comes before it	baby → babies, lady → ladies
4. Add -s if a vowel comes before y	toy → toys, day → days
5. Change f or fe to ves	leaf → leaves, knife → knives
6. Irregular forms (no fixed rule)	man → men, child → children, tooth → teeth
7. Same form in singular and plural	sheep → sheep, species → species
8. Compound nouns – add -s to main word	mother-in-law → mothers-in-law, passer-by → passers-by

Examples in Sentences

- I saw two **men** carrying **boxes**.
- The **children** are playing with **toys**.

- The **wives** cooked delicious food.
- There are many **deer** in the forest.
- The **ladies** wore beautiful **dresses**.

Illustration / Activity

Game: “Change It!”

Teacher says a singular noun, students respond with its plural form.

Example:

Teacher: *foot* → Students: *feet*

Teacher: *knife* → Students: *knives*

Teacher: *table* → Students: *tables*

Evaluation (Grammar)

1. Define a noun.
2. What does “number” mean in grammar?
3. Write the plural of these: *box, baby, loaf, woman, thief*.
4. State four rules for forming plural nouns.
5. Give three examples of nouns that have the same form in both singular and plural.

Assignment (Grammar)

1. Write ten singular nouns and change each to its plural form.
2. Write five sentences using plural nouns correctly.
3. Identify and explain the pluralization rules used in your examples.

WEEK 2

A. READING COMPREHENSION

Topic: Word Meanings through Context

Meaning of Context

In reading, **context** refers to all the words, phrases, sentences, and even the surrounding paragraphs that come before and after an unfamiliar word. It's the "neighborhood" the word lives in.

This skill is one of the most powerful tools a reader has. Instead of stopping to use a dictionary for every new word (which breaks your reading flow), you can use clues from the text to make an intelligent guess—an **inference**—about its meaning. This builds reading speed, confidence, and vocabulary.

Techniques for Getting Word Meanings through Context

We can use several types of clues, often called **context clues**, to unlock the meaning of a word.

i. Definition or Explanation Clues

The text directly provides the definition or an explanation of the word.

- **Signal Words:** Look for words and punctuation like *is*, *are*, *means*, *is called*, *or*, *that is*, *in other words*, as well as commas (,), dashes (—), or parentheses ().
- **Example 1:** The **anthology**, which is a collection of poems, was beautifully bound.
- **Example 2:** **Semantics**, *the study of word meanings*, is a fascinating branch of linguistics.
- **Example 3:** A **pandemic**—a disease that spreads across the entire world—changed life for everyone.

ii. Synonym or Restatement Clues

A more familiar word or phrase with a similar meaning is used nearby.

- **Signal Words:** Look for words like *or, that is, in other words*. Sometimes, the synonym is just used in the same sentence without a signal.
- **Example 1:** The boy was **elated**, or *very happy*, after winning the prize.
- **Example 2:** He was known for his **timorous** nature; he was *scared* of almost everything.
- **Example 3:** She found the task **arduous** and *difficult* to complete.

iii. Antonym or Contrast Clues

The text provides a word or phrase with the opposite meaning, which helps you understand the unfamiliar word.

- **Signal Words:** Look for words like *but, however, unlike, on the other hand, whereas, not*.
- **Example 1:** Unlike his **gloomy** sister, John is always *cheerful*. (Gloomy must mean the opposite of cheerful, so *sad* or *unhappy*.)
- **Example 2:** Some students were **diligent** in their studies, *but* others were simply *lazy*. (Diligent must mean the opposite of lazy, so *hardworking*.)
- **Example 3:** I expected a **cacophony**, *however*, the music was surprisingly *harmonious*. (Cacophony must mean a *harsh, unharmonious sound*.)

iv. Example Clues

The text gives examples that help illustrate the meaning of the word.

- **Signal Words:** Look for words like *such as, for example, including, like*.
- **Example 1:** Nigerian **delicacies** *such as jollof rice, moi-moi, and pounded yam* are delicious. (Delicacies must mean *special, tasty foods*.)
- **Example 2:** **Celestial** bodies, *including the sun, moon, and stars*, have fascinated humans for centuries. (Celestial must mean *related to the sky or outer space*.)
- **Example 3:** He enjoys **aquatic** sports *like swimming and water polo*. (Aquatic must mean *related to water*.)

v. Inference or General Context Clues

The reader must use reasoning and the information in the surrounding text to figure out the word's meaning. This is the most common clue type.

- **Example 1:** After walking for hours under the hot sun, she was completely **exhausted**. (The situation—walking for hours in the heat—leads you to infer that *exhausted* means *very tired*.)
- **Example 2:** The **culprit** was identified by the police from the CCTV footage and was promptly arrested. (The words "police," "identified," and "arrested" help you infer that *culprit* means *the person guilty of a crime*.)
- **Example 3:** The classroom was in **disarray**; books were on the floor, chairs were overturned, and a broken window let in the rain. (The description of the room helps you infer that *disarray* means *a state of untidiness or chaos*.)

Reading Practice

Read the passage below. Using the context clues, determine the meanings of the words in **bold**.

The annual village festival was a **boisterous** event. Unlike the quiet, **sombre** mood of the previous month following the drought, this celebration was full of life. The air was filled with the **aroma** of roasting yams and simmering stew. Children ran everywhere, their shouts and laughter adding to the happy **clamour**. The elders, remembering past celebrations, prayed that the **prolific** harvest would continue for many years to come.

- **Boisterous:** The passage says the event was "full of life" and filled with "shouts and laughter." This is an *inference clue*. **Boisterous** means *noisy, energetic, and cheerful*.
- **Sombre:** The passage uses the antonym clue "Unlike" to contrast this word with the "boisterous" (happy, lively) event. **Sombre** must mean *dark, dull, or sad*.
- **Aroma:** This word is followed by the *example clues* "of roasting yams and simmering stew." **Aroma** means *a pleasant smell, especially from food*.
- **Clamour:** The text mentions "shouts and laughter" as part of the clamour. This is an *inference clue*. **Clamour** means *a loud and confused noise*.
- **Prolific:** The elders "prayed that the... harvest would continue." This implies the harvest was very good. **Prolific** means *producing a great quantity; plentiful*.

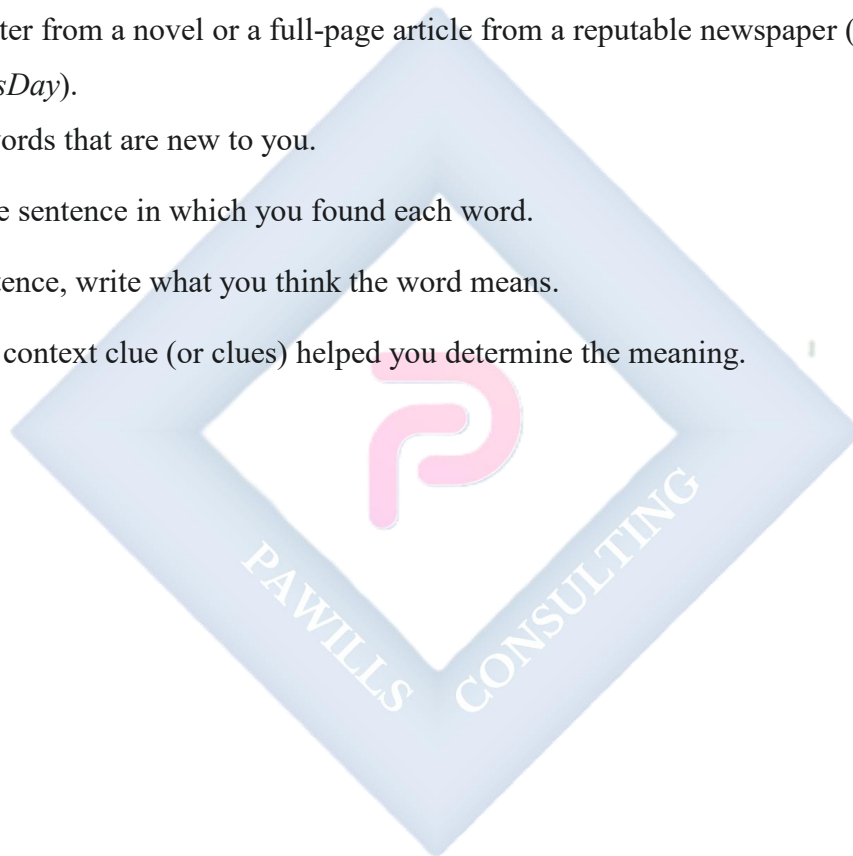
Evaluation (Reading Comprehension)

1. What is meant by "context" in reading, and why is it important?

2. List and explain four types of context clues, giving one new example for each.
3. How does an antonym clue differ from a synonym clue?
4. Read the sentence: "The student was **admonished** by the principal for his bad behaviour, but his parents simply praised him." What does **admonished** mean, and which clue helped you?
5. From the reading practice passage, explain the meaning of "aroma" and "sombre."

Assignment (Reading Comprehension)

1. Read one chapter from a novel or a full-page article from a reputable newspaper (e.g., *The Guardian*, *ThisDay*).
2. Identify five words that are new to you.
3. Write down the sentence in which you found each word.
4. Below the sentence, write what you think the word means.
5. Explain *which* context clue (or clues) helped you determine the meaning.



B. VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT

Topic: Vocabulary Associated with Family Life

Meaning of Family Life

Family life refers to the relationships, roles, interactions, activities, and responsibilities that occur within a family unit. This vocabulary is essential for describing our own lives, understanding social structures, and interpreting literature.

A **family** can be a **nuclear family** (parents and their children) or an **extended family** (including grandparents, aunts, uncles, and cousins, often living together or nearby).

Important Family-Related Vocabulary

Here is a list of common words used to discuss family life.

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Parents	A father and mother.	My parents helped me with my homework.
Siblings	Brothers and sisters.	I have three siblings —two brothers and one sister.
Spouse	A person's husband or wife.	The staff members were invited to the party with their spouses .
Relatives	Members of your extended family.	All our relatives came for the wedding.
Ancestor	A person, typically one more remote than a grandparent, from whom one is descended.	Our ancestors were great warriors from Benin.
Descendant	A person who is related to someone from a past generation.	He is a direct descendant of the town's founder.
Nephew	The son of one's brother or sister.	My brother's son is my nephew , John.

Niece	The daughter of one's brother or sister.	My sister's daughter is my niece , Ada.
Cousin	The child of one's uncle or aunt.	My cousin is studying medicine at the university.
In-laws	The relatives of one's spouse (e.g., mother-in-law, brother-in-law).	My mother-in-law is a very kind woman.
Fiancé	A man who is engaged to be married. (Note the single 'e')	Her fiancé works in the bank.
Fiancée	A woman who is engaged to be married. (Note the double 'e')	His fiancée is from Delta State.
Widow	A woman whose husband has died.	The widow was supported by her children.
Widower	A man whose wife has died.	The widower found it difficult to raise his children alone.
Orphan	A child whose parents are dead.	The orphan was taken in by a kind family.
Naming Ceremony	A special occasion where a newborn baby is officially given a name.	We attended a grand naming ceremony last Sunday.
Polygamy	The practice of having more than one spouse at the same time.	Polygamy is a recognized part of some cultures.
Monogamy	The practice of being married to only one person at a time.	Monogamy is the most common form of marriage in Europe.

Illustration: The Family Tree

A family tree is a diagram that shows relationships between family members. It helps to visualize how everyone is connected.



A simple family tree:

- At the top, you have **Grandparents** (Grandfather and Grandmother).
- They have children: your **Father** and your **Uncle** (his brother).
- Your Father married your **Mother**. Your Uncle married your **Aunt**.
- Your Parents had you and your **Siblings**.
- Your Uncle and Aunt had children, who are your **Cousins**.

Practice Exercise

Fill in the blanks with the correct words from the vocabulary list:

1. My father's brother is my _____.
2. My sister's daughter is my _____.
3. A man whose wife has died is called a _____.
4. My aunt's children are my _____.

5. A family unit with only parents and children is a _____ family.
6. The practice of having only one husband or wife at a time is called _____.
7. A woman engaged to be married is called a _____.
8. My mother's mother is my _____.

Evaluation (Vocabulary Development)

1. Define the term "family life."
2. Distinguish between a "nuclear family" and an "extended family."
3. What is the difference between a "nephew" and a "niece"?
4. Who is a "fiancé," and how is it different from a "fiancée"?
5. Use the words "ancestor" and "spouse" in two separate, correct sentences.

Assignment (Vocabulary Development)

1. Draw your own family tree, going back to your grandparents. Label at least ten members with their relationship to you (e.g., "Father," "Maternal Aunt," "Cousin").
2. Write ten new sentences, each using a *different* word from the vocabulary table above.
3. In a short paragraph, explain why understanding family relationships is important in Nigerian society.

C. LISTENING COMPREHENSION

Topic: National Values through Literary Selections

Meaning of Listening Comprehension

Listening comprehension is an **active** skill. It is not just *hearing* sounds. It is the ability to *understand, interpret, evaluate, and remember* spoken language. This includes identifying main ideas, specific details, the speaker's tone, and any underlying messages or moral lessons.

2. Listening Activity: Identifying National Values

National Values are the shared beliefs and principles that are considered important for the well-being of a nation. These include **honesty, integrity, discipline, unity, patriotism, and respect for elders.**

Your teacher will read the following short story (a fable) to you twice. Listen carefully.

Pre-Listening Vocabulary:

- **Grievance:** A complaint or injustice.
- **Unanimously:** All together, with everyone in agreement.
- **Integrity:** The quality of being honest and having strong moral principles.
- **Bounty:** A reward.

Listening Passage: "The Honest Farmer"

In the old village of Kpatakpa, there was a great famine. The King, wanting to test his people, announced a competition. "I will give one bag of seed corn to every farmer," he declared. "Go and plant it. In six months, whoever brings me the most impressive harvest will receive a great bounty and be declared 'Farmer of the Year'."

Adewale, a young farmer known for his integrity, received his seeds. He planted them, watered them, and tended the soil, but nothing grew. His pot remained empty. He watched in despair as his neighbours boasted of their tall, green stalks of corn.

When the day came, farmers lined up with huge pots of corn. Adewale felt ashamed but knew he must be honest. He brought his empty pot before the King. The crowd laughed.

"Silence!" the King boomed. He pointed to Adewale. "This," he announced, "is your 'Farmer of the Year'!"

The crowd gasped. The King explained, "The seeds I gave you were all boiled. They could not grow. When you all saw your seeds failing, you brought corn from your own barns to deceive me. Only this man had the **honesty** and **courage** to bring me the truth. He is the only one worthy of trust." Adewale was rewarded not just with a bounty, but with the leadership of the village granary.

3. Post-Listening Discussion

1. **Main Idea:** What was the main reason the King held the competition?
2. **Specific Detail:** What was wrong with the seeds the King gave out?
3. **Specific Detail:** Why did Adewale bring an empty pot to the King?
4. **Inference (Values):** What national value did Adewale demonstrate?
5. **Inference (Values):** What negative quality did the other farmers demonstrate?
6. **Application:** What is the moral or lesson of this story?

4. Evaluation (Listening Comprehension)

(To be answered based on the listening passage)

1. What is listening comprehension?
2. What problem was the village of Kpatakpa facing at the beginning of the story?
3. What two national values did Adewale display in the story?
4. Why did the King declare Adewale the winner, even though his pot was empty?
5. State two things that can help improve your listening skills (e.g., paying attention, avoiding distractions, asking questions).

5. Assignment (Listening Comprehension)

1. Listen to the national anthem and the national pledge. Write down two (2) national values you can identify from the lyrics (e.g., unity, loyalty, peace).

2. Listen to a short speech by a school official (like your Principal at the assembly) or a news broadcast on the radio/TV. Write a short summary (3-5 sentences) of the main points and one value or lesson you learned.
-



4 D. CONTINUOUS WRITING

Topic: Narrative Composition – "My First Day at College"

1. Meaning of Narrative Writing

A **narrative composition** (or narrative essay) is a piece of writing that tells a story. The story can be a real-life experience (**non-fiction**) or one that you have imagined (**fiction**).

The main **purpose** of narrative writing is to entertain, share an experience, or teach a lesson. A good narrative is interesting, organized, and makes the reader *feel* like they are part of the story.

2. Steps and Features of a Good Narrative

A narrative essay is typically structured with a clear beginning, middle, and end.

i. The Introduction (The Beginning)

- **Goal:** To "hook" the reader and introduce the setting (where/when) and main characters (who).
- **Techniques:**
 - **Action:** Start with an exciting event. (e.g., *The alarm blared, jolting me from a dream.*)
 - **Dialogue:** Start with someone speaking. (e.g., *"Wake up! You'll be late for your first day!" my mother shouted.*)
 - **Description:** Paint a vivid picture. (e.g., *The new, stiff cotton of my college uniform scratched my neck.*)
 - **Feeling:** Start with a strong emotion. (e.g., *My stomach was a knot of excitement and terror.*)

ii. The Body (The Middle)

- **Goal:** To develop the story and build up to the main event. This is where most of the action happens.
- **Features:**
 - **Chronological Order:** Events are told in the order they happened (first, next, then, later, finally).
 - **Sensory Details:** Use the five senses (sight, sound, smell, taste, touch) to make the story "real."

- **Vivid Verbs & Adjectives:** Use strong words. (Don't say "walk," say "trudged," "raced," or "strolled.")
- **Conflict:** Introduce a problem or a challenge (e.g., getting lost, meeting a bully, feeling homesick).

iii. The Climax

- **Goal:** This is the peak of the story, the most exciting or important moment, the "turning point." The main conflict is faced here.
- **Example:** For "My First Day," the climax could be mistakenly entering the SS3 classroom, or finally meeting a kind friend.

iv. The Conclusion (The End)

- **Goal:** To wrap up the story and give the reader a sense of completion.
- **Techniques:**
 - **Reflection:** State what you learned or how you felt afterwards. (e.g., *I learned that day that being brave wasn't about not being...*)
 - **Feeling:** End with the final emotion you had. (e.g., *As I lay in bed that night, I smiled, knowing I was finally a college student.*)
 - **Full Circle:** Link back to the introduction.

3. Sample Outline: "My First Day at College"

- **Title:** My First Day at College
- **Introduction:**
 - Start with the feeling of dread and excitement on the morning of the first day.
 - Describe the new uniform and the heavy, unfamiliar bag.
 - The noisy bus ride to the school gate, which looked huge and intimidating.
- **Body:**
 - **Event 1 (Conflict):** Getting lost. Describe the confusion of the huge campus, the identical buildings, and the sea of new faces.

- **Event 2 (Details):** Arriving at the assembly ground. Describe the booming voice of the principal and the "scary" looks of the senior students.
- **Event 3 (Action):** Going to the first class (e.g., Integrated Science). Describe the teacher and the first new friends (or lack of).
- **Climax:**
 - During the break, I couldn't find the toilets.
 - I rounded a corner and walked straight into the tallest, meanest-looking student I had ever seen. I stammered, asking for directions.
 - Instead of being mean, he laughed, pointed me in the right direction, and said, "Don't worry, *JJC* [Johnny Just Come], you'll get used to it."
- **Conclusion:**
 - Reflection on the day: It was not as scary as I thought.
 - The feeling of relief and the realization that the "scary" senior was actually kind.
 - End with a feeling of hope for the rest of the term.

4. Evaluation (Continuous Writing)

1. Define narrative writing and state its main purpose.
2. List the four main parts of a narrative composition.
3. What are "sensory details," and why are they important?
4. Write a strong *introduction* (3-4 sentences) for a story titled "The Day I Got Lost."
5. List three sequence connectors (transition words) used in narrative writing.

5. Assignment (Continuous Writing)

1. Write a full narrative essay of about 250-300 words (one page) on the topic: **"My Most Embarrassing Moment."**
2. Remember to use the four-part structure (Intro, Body, Climax, Conclusion), sensory details, and the past tense.

3. **Peer Review:** After writing, exchange your essay with a classmate. Read their story and provide one compliment (what they did well) and one suggestion for improvement.



E. GRAMMAR

Topic: Nouns and Gender

1. Meaning of Gender

In English grammar, **gender** is a way of classifying nouns as masculine (male), feminine (female), common (either male or female), or neuter (no gender).

It is important to note that grammatical gender in English is *natural*—it is based on the real-world sex of the object, unlike in languages like French or German where even inanimate objects are "male" or "female."

THE FOUR GENDERS IN ENGLISH

1. Masculine Gender

Refers to male beings (people or animals).

- **Examples:** man, boy, uncle, king, father, bull, actor, prince, husband, widower, stallion, wizard, fox, groom.

-

2. Feminine Gender

Refers to female beings (people or animals).

- **Examples:** woman, girl, aunt, queen, mother, cow, actress, princess, wife, widow, mare, witch, vixen, bride.

-

3. Common Gender

Refers to beings that can be *either* male or female.

- **Examples:** teacher, child, doctor, student, cousin, friend, parent, baby, monarch, person, relative, singer, artist, driver.

4. Neuter Gender

Refers to non-living things, objects, or ideas that have no gender.

- **Examples:** table, pen, book, car, stone, chair, school, computer.
- **Note:** Abstract nouns (e.g., love, honesty, fear, happiness) are also neuter gender.

GENDER CONVERSION TABLE

Many masculine nouns have a distinct feminine form.

Masculine	Feminine
Actor	Actress
Prince	Princess
Husband	Wife
Nephew	Niece
Lion	Lioness
Bull	Cow
King	Queen
Father	Mother
Uncle	Aunt
Cock (Rooster)	Hen
Sir	Madam
Wizard	Witch
Widower	Widow
Groom (or Bridegroom)	Bride
Fox	Vixen
Stallion (Horse)	Mare

PRACTICE ACTIVITIES

1. **Matching:** Match the masculine nouns in Column A with their feminine counterparts in Column B.
2. **Categorizing:** The teacher provides a list of 20 nouns. Students work in groups to place each noun under the correct heading: Masculine, Feminine, Common, or Neuter.
3. **Sentence Transformation:** Change the gender of the noun in the sentence and make any other necessary changes.
 - *Example:* The **king** spoke to his subjects.
 - *Answer:* The **queen** spoke to her subjects.

EVALUATION (GRAMMAR)

1. Define grammatical gender.
2. List and explain the four genders in English.
3. Give five (5) examples of **Common Gender** nouns.
4. Give five (5) examples of **Neuter Gender** nouns.
5. Write the feminine forms of these words:
 - (a) Nephew
 - (b) Husband
 - (c) Prince
 - (d) Bull
 - (e) Widower
6. What gender does the word "doctor" belong to, and why?

ASSIGNMENT (GRAMMAR)

1. Create your own table of ten pairs of masculine and feminine nouns (do not use more than five from the table above).

2. Walk around your classroom or home. Identify and list:
 - (a) Ten (10) nouns of the **Neuter Gender**.
 - (b) Five (5) nouns of the **Common Gender** (e.g., student, teacher).
3. Write five short sentences, each using one *common gender* noun (e.g., "The *child* was crying.").



WEEK 3

🎧 A. SPOKEN ENGLISH (ORAL ENGLISH)

Topic: Selected Consonant Sounds (The Fricatives: /θ/, /ð/, /ʃ/, /ʒ/, /z/)

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Identify the five consonant sounds: /θ/, /ð/, /ʃ/, /ʒ/, and /z/.
- Describe the correct production of each sound (place and manner of articulation).
- Distinguish between voiced and voiceless sounds.
- Recognize these sounds in different word positions (initial, medial, final).
- Accurately pronounce words containing these sounds in isolation and in sentences.

2. Introduction to Fricatives

The sounds we are studying today are called **fricatives**. A fricative is a consonant sound produced by forcing air through a *narrow gap* so that a *hissing* or *friction* sound is produced.

These sounds are often difficult for Nigerian speakers of English because many of our local languages do not use the same tongue and teeth positions. For example, we often replace:

- /θ/ (as in "think") with /t/ (as in "tink")
- /ð/ (as in "this") with /d/ (as in "dis")
- /ʃ/ (as in "she") with /s/ (as in "see")

This lesson will teach you how to produce them correctly.

3. Sound Descriptions and Production

i. The /θ/ Sound (Voiceless Dental Fricative)

- **Description:** This is a **voiceless** sound. If you touch your throat (Adam's apple), you should feel *no vibration*. It is **dental** because your tongue touches your teeth.
- **How to Produce:**
 1. Place the very tip of your tongue *lightly* between your upper and lower front teeth (or just behind the upper teeth).
 2. Breathe out, forcing air to pass between your tongue and teeth.
 3. Do NOT vibrate your vocal cords. It should sound like a soft "hiss."
- **Common Spellings:** th
- **Word Examples:**
 - **Initial:** think, thin, theme, three, thief, thunder
 - **Medial:** author, bathroom, method, pathetic, nothing
 - **Final:** bath, mouth, path, cloth, breath, fourth

ii. The /ð/ Sound (Voiced Dental Fricative)

- **Description:** This is a **voiced** sound. If you touch your throat, you *must* feel a **vibration**. It is the "sister sound" to /θ/.
- **How to Produce:**
 1. Place your tongue in the *exact same position* as /θ/ (tip between the teeth).
 2. As you force air out, *hum* or *vibrate* your vocal cords. It should make a "buzzing" sound.
- **Common Spellings:** th
- **Word Examples:**
 - **Initial:** this, that, the, them, then, though
 - **Medial:** mother, father, brother, weather, other
 - **Final:** breathe, bathe, cloothe, suithe (Note: This sound is rare at the very end of words).

Key Contrast:

- breath /breθ/ (noun) - no voice
- breathe /bri:ð/ (verb) - with voice
- bath /bæθ/ (noun) - no voice
- bathe /beɪð/ (verb) - with voice

iii. The /ʃ/ Sound (Voiceless Palato-alveolar Fricative)

- **Description:** This is a **voiceless** sound (no vibration). It is the "be quiet" sound.
- **How to Produce:**
 1. Round your lips slightly (as if you are about to say "oo").
 2. Raise the front/middle of your tongue towards the hard roof (palate) of your mouth, just behind the small ridge (alveolar ridge).
 3. Force air out over the tongue.
- **Common Spellings:** sh, ti, si, ci, ch (in some words)
- **Word Examples:**
 - **Initial:** she, ship, shop, shout, sure, sugar
 - **Medial:** nation, station, motion, press~~ion~~, ancient, machine, Chicago
 - **Final:** fish, wash, push, cash, dish

iv. The /ʒ/ Sound (Voiced Palato-alveolar Fricative)

- **Description:** This is a **voiced** sound (with vibration). It is the "sister sound" to /ʃ/. This sound is less common in English.
- **How to Produce:**
 1. Place your tongue and lips in the *exact same position* as /ʃ/ (lips rounded, tongue raised).
 2. As you force air out, *vibrate* your vocal cords.
- **Common Spellings:** s, si, ge (often in the middle or end of words)
- **Word Examples:**

- **Initial:** *This is very rare.* genre /ʒɒnrə/
- **Medial:** measure, pleasure, treasure, vision, television, usual
- **Final:** beige, garage, mirage, rouge

v. The /z/ Sound (Voiced Alveolar Fricative)

- **Description:** This is a **voiced** sound (with vibration). It is the sound a bee or zipper makes. It is the voiced "sister" to /s/.
- **How to Produce:**
 1. Place your tongue in the same position as /s/ (tip near the alveolar ridge, but not touching).
 2. Force air out while *vibrating* your vocal cords.
- **Common Spellings:** z, s (very common)
- **Word Examples:**
 - **Initial:** zoo, zebra, zip, zero
 - **Medial:** lazy, easy, music, busy, prison, puzzle
 - **Final:** is, was, has, breeze, freeze, please, noise

Minimal Pairs for Practice

Minimal pairs are two words that are identical in every way *except* for one sound. Practicing these aloud will train your ear and your tongue.

Contrast	Pair 1	Pair 2	Pair 3
/θ/ vs /ð/	thin /θɪn/	this /ðɪs/	breath /breθ/
/ʃ/ vs /ʒ/	mission /mɪʃən/	vision /vɪʒən/	pressure /preʃə/
/s/ vs /ʃ/	sip /sɪp/	ship /ʃɪp/	see /si:/
/z/ vs /ʒ/	<i>rare contrast</i>		
/s/ vs /z/	price /praɪs/	prize /praɪz/	sip /sɪp/
/t/ vs /θ/ (Error)	tink /tɪŋk/	think /θɪŋk/	tree /tri:/
/d/ vs /ð/ (Error)	den /den/	then /ðen/	day /deɪ/

5. Sentence Practice (Drills)

Practice saying these sentences clearly, paying attention to the target sounds.

1. ***/θ/ and /ð/:**
 - **Their father thinks that this thing** is better **than that thing**.
 - My brother took a **bath** /bæθ/ and **then** went to **bathe** /beɪð/ **the** dog.
 - **They thanked the author for the thoroughly** good book.
2. ***/f/ and /z/:**
 - She usually measures the treasure on **television**.
 - The **explosion** caused **confusion** in the **garage**.
 - It was a pleasure to **wash** Sheila's **special beige shirt**.
3. ***/z/ and other sounds:**
 - **Zainab's** lazy cousins refused to pick the beans.
 - She sells **seashells**, but his prize is his **zebra**.

6. Evaluation

1. Define a "fricative" sound.
2. Explain the main difference between /θ/ and /ð/. Which one is voiced?
3. Explain the main difference between /f/ and /z/. Which one is voiceless?
4. Write the phonetic symbol for the sound in bold:
 - **father**
 - **sheep**
 - **measure**
 - **thin**
 - **zoo**
5. Pronounce the following words for your teacher: this, think, pleasure, pressure, easy, nation.

7. Assignment

1. Write ten words you can find in a newspaper or textbook that contain the th spelling. Sort them into two columns: those pronounced /θ/ and those pronounced /ð/.
2. Write five sentences that each contain *at least one* word with the /ʃ/ sound and *one* word with the /z/ sound. (e.g., "The *station's decision* was final.")
3. **(Practical):** Use a phone to record yourself reading the "Sentence Practice" drills. Listen back and identify one sound you need to work on.



B. VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT

Topic: Vocabulary Associated with Agriculture

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define "agriculture" and explain its importance.
- Identify and understand at least 20 new words related to farming.
- Categorize agricultural vocabulary into logical groups.
- Use these new words correctly in sentences.

Introduction

Agriculture is the science, art, or practice of cultivating the soil, producing crops, and raising livestock (animals) for food, wool, and other products. It is the backbone of Nigeria's economy and provides the food we eat every day. This field has a specialized vocabulary.

Categorized Vocabulary Lists

i. Farming Activities & Processes

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Cultivation	The act of preparing and using land for growing crops.	Cultivation of the land began after the first rain.
Tillage	The preparation of land by digging, ploughing, or overturning it.	Tillage helps to loosen the soil and control weeds.
Planting	Putting seeds or young plants (seedlings) into the soil.	The farmers are planting maize for the new season.
Weeding	The act of removing unwanted plants (weeds) from a farm.	Weeding is essential so crops can get enough nutrients.
Pruning	Cutting off dead or unwanted branches	The farmer was pruning the cocoa

	from a tree or plant.	trees to improve the yield.
Staking	Supporting a plant with sticks (stakes) to help it grow upright.	Staking is necessary for plants like yams and tomatoes.
Harvesting	The process of gathering mature crops from the fields.	Harvesting the yams is hard but rewarding work.
Irrigation	Supplying land with water using artificial means (e.g., pipes, canals).	They use irrigation to farm during the dry season.
Grazing	When animals (like cows or goats) feed on growing grass.	The cattle were grazing peacefully in the field.

ii. Tools, Equipment & Farm Structures

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Hoe	A common hand tool with a flat blade used for digging and weeding.	My grandmother uses a hoe on her small farm.
Cutlass	A short, heavy, single-edged sword used for clearing bush.	He used a cutlass to clear a path through the weeds.
Tractor	A powerful motor vehicle used for pulling farm machinery.	A tractor can plough a large field in one day.
Plough	A large farm tool used to turn over the soil before planting.	The plough was pulled by two bulls.
Silo	A tall, airtight tower used for storing grain or fodder (animal feed).	The farmer stored the harvested maize in the silo .
Barn	A large farm building used for storing hay or housing livestock.	They kept the yams in the barn to keep them dry.
Pantry	A small room or cupboard where food is stored.	My mother keeps bags of rice and beans in the pantry .

iii. Crops, Soil & Nutrients

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Crop	A plant (like cassava, maize, or rice) grown by farmers.	Yam is a very important crop in this region.
Seedling	A very young plant that has grown from a	He carefully watered the tomato

	seed.	seedlings.
Fertility	The ability of soil to support plant growth.	Crop rotation helps to maintain soil fertility.
Manure	Natural fertilizer from animal dung (waste).	Spreading manure on the farm enriches the soil.
Fertilizer	A chemical or natural substance added to soil to increase fertility.	You must apply fertilizer if you want a big harvest.
Pesticide	A chemical used to kill insects or other pests that destroy crops.	Farmers spray pesticides to protect their cotton.
Erosion	The process of soil being washed or blown away by water or wind.	Planting trees can help prevent soil erosion.

Evaluation

1. Define "agriculture" in your own words.
2. What is the difference between "pruning" and "staking"?
3. List three common farm tools and their uses.
4. Explain the difference between "manure" and "fertilizer."
5. Fill in the blanks with appropriate words from the lesson:
 - (a) The process of gathering ripe yams from the farm is called _____.
 - (b) A farmer uses _____ to kill insects on his crops.
 - (c) A tall tower used for storing grain is a _____.
 - (d) To grow crops in the dry season, a farmer might need an _____ system.
 - (e) The act of removing unwanted plants is called _____.

Assignment

1. Draw and label five common farm tools (e.g., hoe, cutlass, rake, shovel, wheelbarrow).

2. Write a short paragraph (about 100 words) titled "A Day on My Father's Farm." You must use *at least* six (6) of the new vocabulary words from this lesson (e.g., cultivation, hoe, weeding, harvest, barn, crops).
3. List three "cash crops" (grown for sale) and three "staple crops" (eaten by the family) in your community.



C. READING COMPREHENSION

Topic: Understanding Word Meanings Through Context

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Identify unfamiliar words in a passage.
- Apply context-clue skills (from Week 2) to determine the meaning of those words.
- Answer comprehension questions based on the passage.

Skill Focus: Recap of Context Clues

As we learned last week, we don't always need a dictionary. The "context" (the words and sentences *around* a new word) gives us clues.

- **Definition Clue:** The meaning is given. (e.g., "A *silo*, which is a tower for storing grain, stood nearby.")
- **Example Clue:** Examples are given. (e.g., "He grows *staple crops* such as yam, cassava, and maize.")
- **Antonym (Contrast) Clue:** The opposite is stated. (e.g., "The old farmer preferred *manual* methods, but his son used *mechanized* tools like tractors.")
- **Inference Clue:** You must use logic. (e.g., "The soil was *barren*; nothing would grow on it.")

Practice Passage

Read the passage below carefully. The words in **bold** are your target words.

Modern agriculture is very different from the farming of our ancestors. In the past, most farming was **subsistence** farming, where farmers grew just enough food to feed their own families. They used **rudimentary** tools like hoes and cutlasses and relied on **manure** (animal waste) to improve soil fertility.

Today, many farms are large-scale, commercial operations. This **mechanized** farming uses complex machinery like tractors for ploughing and harvesters for gathering crops. Instead of just manure, farmers now use chemical **fertilizers** to enrich the soil and **pesticides** to protect crops from insects. While this is more efficient, it can be expensive.

A major challenge for all farmers is **erosion**, the process where wind or water wears away the rich topsoil. Another is drought. To combat a lack of rain, some farms have built complex **irrigation** systems, using pipes and sprinklers to water the fields. The goal is to ensure a **bountiful** harvest, one that is plentiful and feeds the nation.

Comprehension Questions

1. What is the main topic of this passage?
2. According to the passage, what is the difference between "subsistence" farming and "commercial" farming?
3. What are two tools associated with "rudimentary" farming?
4. What two modern methods are used to protect crops or improve the soil?
5. What problem do "irrigation" systems solve?

Evaluation (Focus on Context Clues)

1. Find the word "**subsistence**" in the passage. From its context, what does it mean?
2. Find the word "**rudimentary**". The passage gives hoes and cutlasses as examples. What do you think "rudimentary" means (e.g., simple or complex)?
3. Find the word "**mechanized**". The passage contrasts it with "rudimentary" tools and gives tractors as an example. What does "mechanized" mean?
4. Find the word "**erosion**". The passage provides a *definition clue*. What is the definition of erosion?
5. Find the word "**bountiful**". The passage uses a *synonym clue* ("plentiful") right after it. What does a "bountiful harvest" mean?

Assignment

1. Read the practice passage again. Write your own sentences using the following words:
subsistence, mechanized, erosion, irrigation.
2. Write a short paragraph (3-5 sentences) on the topic: "Why Farming is Important to Nigeria."
Try to use at least two words from the vocabulary list.



WEEK 4

A. GRAMMAR

Topic: Countable and Uncountable Nouns

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define and differentiate between countable and uncountable (mass) nouns.
- Correctly identify the plural forms of regular and common irregular countable nouns.
- Understand the rules for using articles (a, an, the) and quantifiers (many, much, few, little) with both types of nouns.
- Identify and correctly use special-case nouns (e.g., *news*, *trousers*).

2. Countable Nouns (Count Nouns)

Definition: Countable nouns are nouns that represent individual items that can be **counted** as separate units. They have both a singular and a plural form.

- **Singular Form:** Refers to one item.
 - *Example:* a book, one chair, an idea, a student
- **Plural Form:** Refers to more than one item (usually formed by adding -s, -es, or -ies).
 - *Example:* books, chairs, ideas, students, watches, cities
- **Irregular Plurals:** Some common nouns have irregular plural forms.
 - *Example:* man $\rightarrow$ men, woman $\rightarrow$ women, child $\rightarrow$ children, foot $\rightarrow$ feet, tooth $\rightarrow$ teeth, person $\rightarrow$ people, mouse $\rightarrow$ mice

Key Usage Rules:

1. In their singular form, they **must** have a determiner before them (e.g., a, an, the, my, this).
 - *Incorrect:* I saw **bird** fly.

- *Correct:* I saw **a bird** fly. / I saw **that bird** fly.
- 2. They work with quantifiers that imply number.
 - **Quantifiers:** many, few, a few, several, a number of, these, those.
 - *Example:* **Many students** attended the lecture.
 - *Example:* We have **a few chairs** to spare.

3. Uncountable Nouns (Mass Nouns)

Definition: Uncountable nouns refer to substances, materials, concepts, or masses that **cannot be counted** as individual items. They are seen as a whole or a mass.

- They do **not** have a plural form. (We don't say "informations," "advices," or "furnitures").
- They are always treated as **singular** in a sentence (they take a singular verb).
 - *Example:* The **water is** cold. (Not: The water *are* cold.)
 - *Example:* This **information is** vital. (Not: These information *are* vital.)

Common Categories of Uncountable Nouns:

- **Liquids/Gases:** water, milk, oil, petrol, air, oxygen
- **Materials/Substances:** wood, glass, paper, gold, rice, sugar, flour, cement
- **Abstract Ideas/Emotions:** information, advice, news, knowledge, happiness, love, courage, fun
- **General Categories:** furniture (a collection of chairs, tables, etc.), luggage/baggage (a collection of bags), money, traffic
- **Subjects/Activities:** mathematics, physics, economics, politics, football, swimming

Key Usage Rules:

1. We **cannot** use a or an directly with them.
 - *Incorrect:* He gave me **an advice**.
2. To "count" them, we use **partitives** (units of measurement).
 - *Correct:* He gave me **a piece of** advice.
 - *More examples:*
 - **a bottle of** water

- a **grain of** rice
 - a **loaf of** bread
 - a **cup of** tea
 - an **item of** news
 - a **piece of** furniture
3. They work with quantifiers that imply amount or quantity.
- **Quantifiers:** much, little, a little, a lot of, plenty of, some, any.
 - *Example:* There isn't **much information** on that topic.
 - *Example:* I need **a little sugar** for my tea.

4. Special Cases and Confusions

Some nouns can be tricky.

1. **Plural Form, Singular Meaning:** These nouns look plural but take a singular verb.
 - **Examples:** news, mathematics, physics, economics, politics, athletics, gymnastics.
 - *Sentence:* The **news is** on at 6 PM.
 - *Sentence:* **Mathematics is** an important subject.
2. **Always Plural (Pluralia Tantum):** These nouns are always plural and take a plural verb. They often refer to items with two parts.
 - **Examples:** trousers, scissors, spectacles (glasses), shorts, jeans, pliers, congratulations, thanks, premises.
 - *Sentence:* My **trousers are** new. (Not: My trouser is new.)
 - *Sentence:* The **scissors are** on the table.
 - *To make them singular:* We use "a pair of..." (e.g., "I bought **a pair of** trousers.")

5. Evaluation

1. What is the main difference between a countable and an uncountable noun?
2. Give three examples of nouns for each of these categories:
 - (a) Abstract Uncountable Nouns
 - (b) Nouns with Irregular Plurals

- (c) Nouns that are always plural
- 3. Identify the nouns in the following sentences and classify them as Countable (C) or Uncountable (U):
 - (a) The **children** drank **water**.
 - (b) The **news** was surprising.
 - (c) We need more **chairs** in this **class**.
 - (d) He bought a new **pair** of **trousers**.
- 4. Correct the errors in the following sentences:
 - (a) She gave me many advices.
 - (b) The furnitures are in the lorry.
 - (c) I need an information about the school.
 - (d) Politics are a dirty game.
 - (e) My jean is torn.

6. Assignment

1. Write ten sentences of your own. In five sentences, use an uncountable noun correctly. In the other five, use a countable noun correctly.
2. Write a short paragraph (about 5-6 lines) describing your classroom. You must use at least four (4) countable nouns and four (4) uncountable nouns. Underline them.

B. LISTENING COMPREHENSION

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this listening session, you should be able to:

- Listen attentively to identify the main idea and specific details in a poem.
- Identify the mood or feeling conveyed in the poem.
- Recognize sound devices like rhyme.

2. Pre-Listening Activity

Your teacher will introduce three key words from the poem. Listen to their meanings.

- **Dawn:** The very beginning of the morning, when light first appears.
- **Lawn:** An area of ground covered in short grass, usually in a garden or park.
- **Bloom:** (verb) To open up; when a flower opens.

3. Listening Activity: "The Rainy Morning"

Your teacher will read the following poem to you twice. Listen carefully.

Poem Title: The Rainy Morning

The rain began at **dawn**,

Falling softly on the **lawn**.

Children stayed inside the room,

Watching flowers start to **bloom**.

The farmer smiled beneath the sky,

For crops will grow when fields are dry.

4. Post-Listening Discussion and Questions

1. What is the poem mainly about?
2. When exactly did the rain begin?
3. Where were the children, and what were they doing?
4. How did the farmer feel about the rain? Why?
5. What does the poet mean by "when fields are dry"? (Inference: It means the rain is welcome *because the fields were dry before*).
6. Identify two pairs of rhyming words from the poem. (e.g., *room/bloom, sky/dry*)

5. Evaluation

1. What is listening comprehension?
2. Mention two reasons why good listening skills are important in life (e.g., for learning, for avoiding danger, for understanding others).
3. State two things a person must do to be a good listener (e.g., pay attention, avoid distractions, not interrupt).
4. What was the *mood* (feeling) of the farmer in the poem? (e.g., happy, pleased, hopeful).
5. What sound device was used at the end of lines 1 and 2 (dawn/lawn)?

6. Assignment

1. Listen to a 5-minute news summary on the radio or television tonight.
2. In your notebook, write down the three main topics or stories that were reported.
3. Write down two new words you heard, find their meanings, and use them in sentences.

C. READING COMPREHENSION

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Read and understand a short passage about a cultural event.
- Identify the main idea and specific details.
- Determine the meaning of words from their context in the passage.

2. Reading Passage

Read the passage below carefully:

Last Saturday, our school organized a **cultural** day celebration. It was a day set aside to appreciate the rich and diverse traditions of our country. Students came in different traditional **attires**, representing various tribes in Nigeria. There were Igbos in their 'isi-agu' outfits, Yorubas in flowing 'agbada', and Hausas in their 'babanriga' and elegant veils.

The event was a feast for the senses. There were **displays** of energetic local dances, mouth-watering traditional dishes, and short drama sketches depicting historical events. Parents and teachers were visibly impressed by the students' **creativity** and talent. In his closing speech, the principal praised everyone for **showcasing** the beauty of our culture, reminding us that "our diversity is our strength."

3. Comprehension Questions

1. What was the purpose of the cultural day celebration?
2. How did the students show the diversity of Nigerian tribes?
3. Mention two specific activities that took place during the celebration.
4. Who was impressed by the students' performances?
5. What was the principal's main message in his speech?

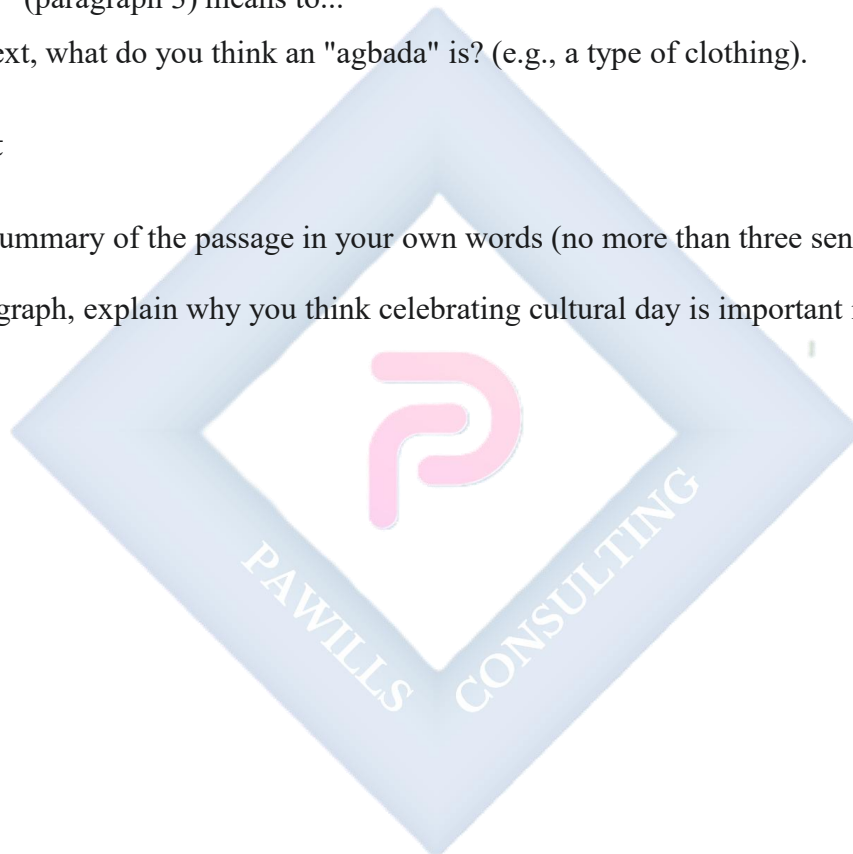
6. What is the main idea of the entire passage?

4. Evaluation (Vocabulary in Context)

1. Find the word "**attires**" in the passage. What does it mean?
2. What does the word "**displays**" mean as used in the second paragraph?
3. The passage says the principal praised the students' "**creativity**". This means he praised their ability to... (e.g., use new ideas, be original).
4. To "**showcase**" (paragraph 3) means to...
5. From the context, what do you think an "agbada" is? (e.g., a type of clothing).

5. Assignment

1. Write a short summary of the passage in your own words (no more than three sentences).
2. In a short paragraph, explain why you think celebrating cultural day is important in a school.



D. CONTINUOUS WRITING

Topic: Narrative Composition – "A Day I Will Never Forget"

1. Meaning of Narrative Writing

A **narrative composition** (or narrative essay) is a piece of writing that tells a story. The story can be a real-life experience (non-fiction) or one that you have imagined (fiction). Its main purpose is to entertain your reader and/or share a significant experience and the lesson you learned from it.

2. Features of a Good Narrative

- **Tense:** Written mostly in the **past tense** (e.g., *I saw, he ran, we were shouting, it had happened*).
- **Structure:** Events are arranged in **chronological order** (the order in which they happened).
- **Point of View:** Usually written in the **first person** (using "I," "me," "we," "our").
- **Key Elements:**
 - **Characters:** The people in the story (e.g., "I," "my mother," "the principal").
 - **Setting:** Where and when the story took place (e.g., "a hot afternoon on the football field").
 - **Plot:** The sequence of events (what happened). This includes an introduction, rising action, a **climax** (the most exciting part), and a resolution.
- **Language:** Uses...
 - **Sensory Details:** What you saw, heard, smelled, tasted, or felt.
 - **Vivid Verbs:** (e.g., "dashed" instead of "ran," "whispered" instead of "said").
 - **Transition Words:** (e.g., *first, next, later, suddenly, finally*).

3. Sample Outline: "A Day I Will Never Forget"

- **Title:** A Day I Will Never Forget
- **Introduction (Paragraph 1):**
 - **Hook:** Start with a sentence that grabs the reader's attention (e.g., *My hands were trembling and my heart was beating like a drum.*)

- **Set the Scene:** Introduce the day, the setting, and the general feeling. (e.g., *It was the day of the state mathematics competition, and I was the one chosen to represent my school.*)
- **Body (Paragraphs 2 & 3 - Rising Action):**
 - Describe the events leading up to the main moment.
 - Build suspense or emotion. (e.g., *The journey to the city, seeing the huge hall, the stern look of the quizmaster...*)
 - Describe the challenge or conflict. (e.g., *The first few questions were impossible. I saw our score falling behind...*)
- **Body (Paragraph 4 - Climax):**
 - The main event! The most exciting part.
 - (e.g., *Then, the final, tie-breaker question came. No one else on my team knew it. All eyes were on me. I took a deep breath and remembered a formula my teacher had shown me just yesterday...*)
- **Conclusion (Paragraph 5):**
 - **Resolution:** What happened in the end?
 - **Reflection:** Explain *why* you will never forget this day. What did you learn? (e.g., *When they announced our school as the winner, the hall erupted. I learned that day that preparation and courage are the keys to success. I will never forget the feeling of pure joy and pride.*)

4. Evaluation

1. What is narrative writing?
2. What is the "climax" of a story?
3. In what tense is a narrative essay usually written?
4. Mention three other key features of a good narrative.
5. Write an engaging *opening paragraph* (3-4 sentences) for a story titled "A Day I Will Never Forget." Make your reader want to continue reading.

5. Assignment

1. Write a full composition (about 250 words) on the topic: **"A Day I Will Never Forget."** (You can write about a happy day, a sad day, a scary day, or an embarrassing day).
2. Ensure you follow the structure (Introduction, Body, Climax, Conclusion).
3. When you are done, read your story and underline five (5) vivid verbs you used (e.g., *dashed*, *screamed*, *whispered*).



E. GRAMMAR (EXTENSION)

Topic: Types of Nouns (Classification)

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define and identify the five main types of nouns.
- Differentiate between abstract and concrete nouns.
- Differentiate between proper and common nouns.

2. Types of Nouns and Examples

This is a summary of how we classify all nouns.

Type	Definition	Examples
Proper Nouns	Names of specific people, places, organizations, or things. They always start with a capital letter.	Nigeria, Mary, Lagos, Coca-Cola, Google, Mr. Ade
Common Nouns	General names of people, places, things, or ideas.	boy, city, table, teacher, country, drink, company
Concrete Nouns	Nouns that you can experience with your five senses (see, touch, hear, smell, or taste).	book, chair, tree, ball, music, perfume, smoke
Abstract Nouns	Nouns that name ideas, feelings, qualities, or concepts. You cannot experience them with your five senses.	love, wisdom, happiness, anger, courage, time, idea
Collective Nouns	Nouns that name a group or collection of people, animals, or things, treated as a single unit.	team, class, herd (of cattle), flock (of birds), crowd, family, army

Note: You can classify one noun in multiple ways!

- "Love" is a **Common**, **Abstract**, and **Uncountable** noun.

- "Book" is a **Common, Concrete, and Countable** noun.
- "Nigeria" is a **Proper, Concrete, and Countable** (one country) noun.

3. Evaluation

1. Define a noun and list its five main types.
2. Give two new examples of each type.
3. Identify and classify ALL the nouns in this sentence:
 - "The class showed kindness to the old man in Abuja."
 - *Example:* **class** = Collective, Common, Concrete, Countable
4. Which type of noun is "beauty"? (Abstract)
5. Explain the main difference between a proper noun and a common noun.

4. Assignment

1. Write five sentences. Each sentence must contain *at least* two different types of nouns.
 - *Example:* My **family** (Collective) has a lot of **love** (Abstract).
2. Identify and classify all the nouns in the following paragraph:
 - "Nigeria is a **country** with great **beauty** and **diversity**. The **people** show **courage** and **unity** during **festivals**."

WEEK 6

🔊 A. SPOKEN ENGLISH (ORAL ENGLISH)

Topic: Consonant Clusters with /w/

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Identify the /w/ sound as a semi-vowel or "glide."
- Recognize and list the common consonant + /w/ clusters: /tw/, /sw/, /kw/, /gw/, /dw/.
- Describe the correct lip and tongue position for producing these clusters.
- Accurately pronounce words containing these clusters in isolation and within sentences.
- Differentiate these blended sounds from two separate, distinct sounds.

2. Introduction: The /w/ Glide

The /w/ sound (as in "wet" or "wow") is a **semi-vowel**, also known as a **glide**. It's not a "full" consonant because air flows smoothly without friction, and it's not a vowel because it can't form a syllable on its own.

How to Produce /w/:

1. **Round your lips** tightly, pushing them forward (like you're about to say "oo").
2. Your tongue should be high and at the back of your mouth.
3. "Glide" from this position into the following vowel sound by unrounding your lips.

When /w/ follows another consonant (like /t/, /s/, /k/, /g/, /d/), it creates a **consonant cluster**. The key is to *merge* the two sounds. You should be rounding your lips for the /w/ *at the same time* as you are forming the first consonant.

Common Error: The most common mistake is pronouncing the two sounds separately (e.g., "tu-win" instead of **twin**) or ignoring the /w/ sound entirely.

3. Detailed Cluster Analysis

i. The /tw/ Cluster

- **Description:** The voiceless alveolar stop /t/ followed by the /w/ glide.
- **How to Produce:** Place the tip of your tongue on the alveolar ridge (just behind your top teeth) for the /t/. *Before* you release the /t/, round your lips for the /w/. Release them together as one sound.
- **Examples:** **twin, twelve, twenty, twist, twig, twilight, between.**

ii. The /dw/ Cluster

- **Description:** The voiced alveolar stop /d/ followed by the /w/ glide.
- **How to Produce:** Same position as /tw/, but you must use your vocal cords for the /d/ sound. Release the voiced /d/ and the /w/ glide together.
- **Examples:** **dwell, dwarf, dwindle, dwelling.**

iii. The /sw/ Cluster

- **Description:** The voiceless alveolar fricative /s/ followed by the /w/ glide.
- **How to Produce:** Start by making the /s/ sound (air hissing over the tongue). *While* you are making the /s/, round your lips for the /w/.
- **Examples:** **sweet, swim, sweep, switch, swear, swing, swan.**

iv. The /kw/ Cluster

- **Description:** The voiceless velar stop /k/ (spelled c, k, or q) followed by the /w/ glide (spelled u or w). This sound is almost always spelled qu.
- **How to Produce:** Raise the back of your tongue to the soft palate (velum) for the /k/. *Before* you release the /k/, round your lips for the /w/.
- **Examples:** **queen, quick, quiet, quake, quarry, question, equal, request.**

v. The /gw/ Cluster

- **Description:** The voiced velar stop /g/ followed by the /w/ glide.
- **How to Produce:** Same position as /kw/, but you must use your vocal cords for the /g/ sound.
- **Examples:** language, anguish, linguist, **Gwen**, **gw**ava, penguin.

4. Practice Drills

Drill 1: Minimal Pairs (for listening and pronunciation)

Repeat these pairs. Listen to the difference between a single consonant and a cluster.

- tick vs. quick
- tip vs. twin (Listen for the /w/)
- sit vs. sweet
- get vs. Gwen
- dell vs. dwell

Drill 2: Sentence Practice

Read the following sentences aloud, focusing on blending the cluster sounds smoothly.

1. The **tw**ins **swe**pt **twen**ty-**two** rooms **qu**ickly.
2. The **Q**ueen spoke **qu**ietly about the **d**warf.
3. **G**wen **sw**am with the **sw**an, **sw**irling in the water.
4. I have a **q**uestion about the **tw**ist in the plot.
5. The **d**windling light of **tw**ilight made the **d**welling look eerie.
6. What is the main **lan**guage spoken by the **G**wen in that **qu**arter?

5. Evaluation

1. What is a "semi-vowel" or "glide," and what is the key lip movement for producing /w/?
2. Describe the error to avoid when pronouncing a word like "twin."
3. Give two new examples for each of these clusters: /tw/, /sw/, /kw/, /gw/.

4. Your teacher will ask you to pronounce the following words. Be prepared to say them clearly:

- twelve
- sweep
- quiet
- language
- dwell
- twenty
- queen
- anguish

6. Assignment

1. Find and write down ten English words (two for each cluster: /tw/, /dw/, /sw/, /kw/, /gw/) that were not used in this lesson.
 2. Write five original sentences. Each sentence must use *at least two* words with any of these consonant + /w/ clusters.
 - (Example: The **queen** made a **quick** request for **twenty-one** sweets.)
 3. (Optional) Record yourself reading the sentences from Practice Drill 2 and listen back. Do your clusters sound like one smooth sound or two separate sounds?
-

B. VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT

Topic: Agriculture (Agricultural Implements)

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define "agricultural implements" and state their importance.
- Differentiate between simple (manual) and mechanized farm implements.
- Identify and describe the use of at least ten different farm tools.

- Use this new vocabulary correctly in sentences.

2. Introduction

Agricultural implements are the tools, devices, and machines used in farming to make work easier, faster, and more efficient. Without these tools, modern farming and food production would be impossible. We can group them into two main categories:

1. **Simple/Manual Implements:** Hand tools powered by human effort. They are common on subsistence farms or for small-scale tasks.
2. **Mechanized Implements:** Machines powered by engines (like tractors) or electricity. They are used for large-scale, commercial farming.

3. Simple Farm Implements (Manual Tools)

Implement	Description and Use
Hoe	A tool with a flat blade on a long handle, used for digging, removing weeds, and making ridges.
Cutlass	A long, heavy, single-edged blade, used for clearing thick grass, bushes, and small trees.
Rake	A tool with a "comb" of teeth (tines), used for gathering leaves, smoothing soil, or removing debris.
Spade	A tool with a flat, sharp-edged blade, used for digging, lifting, and turning soil (especially for making holes).
Shovel	A tool with a broad, curved blade, used for scooping and moving loose materials like sand, manure, or grain.

Implement	Description and Use
Wheelbarrow	A small cart with one wheel, used for carrying and transporting loads (crops, manure, tools) by hand.
Sickle	A tool with a short, curved blade, used for harvesting grasses or grain crops like rice.
Watering Can	A container with a spout, used for watering plants by hand.

4. Mechanized Farm Implements (Machines)

Implement	Description and Use
Tractor	The main vehicle of a farm. It provides the power to pull or operate most other mechanized implements.
Plough	A large, heavy implement pulled by a tractor to cut deep into the soil and turn it over, burying weeds and preparing the land for planting.
Harrow	Used <i>after</i> ploughing. It breaks up large clumps of soil and creates a finer, smoother seedbed.
Ridger	An implement that forms long, raised hills of soil (ridges) for planting crops like yam, cassava, or potatoes.
Planter / Seeder	A machine that automatically sows (plants) seeds in the soil at a uniform depth and spacing.

Implement	Description and Use
Harvester	A large, complex machine that cuts, threshes (separates), and collects mature grain crops like maize, rice, or wheat.
Sprayer	A machine (often attached to a tractor) that applies liquid pesticides, herbicides, or fertilizers to crops.

5. Practice: Fill in the Blanks

Use the words from the vocabulary list to complete the passage.

To prepare his large farm for planting maize, the farmer first used a (1) _____ pulled by his tractor to turn over the soil. The ground was still lumpy, so he pulled a (2) _____ over it to smooth it out. For the smaller vegetable garden, his son used a (3) _____ to dig up the weeds and a (4) _____ to carry manure to the plots. To plant the yams, they needed a (5) _____ to make raised beds of soil.

(Answers: 1. plough, 2. harrow, 3. hoe, 4. wheelbarrow, 5. ridger)

6. Evaluation

1. Define "agricultural implements" in one sentence.
2. What is the main difference between a **hoe** and a **cutlass**?
3. What is the main difference between a **plough** and a **harrow**? Which one is used first?
4. Explain the function of these three implements:
 - (a) Harvester
 - (b) Tractor
 - (c) Wheelbarrow
5. Why is mechanized farming more efficient than manual farming?

7. Assignment

1. Draw and label five different farm implements (at least two manual and two mechanized).
 2. Write a short paragraph (about 100 words) on the topic: "The Importance of Farm Mechanization in Nigeria." You must use at least five words from this lesson (e.g., *tractor*, *plough*, *harvester*, *efficient*, *crops*).
 3. Ask a parent or guardian about two farm tools they know and write down what they are used for.
-

C. LISTENING COMPREHENSION

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this listening session, you should be able to:

- Listen attentively to a passage and identify the main idea.
- Extract specific details (who, where, what, why) from the passage.
- Infer the moral or lesson of the story.

2. Pre-Listening Activity

Your teacher will read a passage. Before you listen, let's understand three key words:

- **Produce (noun):** Farm products, like fruits and vegetables, that have been grown.
- **Dedication:** Being committed and working very hard for something.
- **Community:** A group of people living in the same place.

3. Listening Activity

Your teacher will read the following passage to you twice. Listen carefully for the answers to the "who, what, where, when, and why."

Passage Title: The Hardworking Farmer

Mr. Bassey is a hardworking farmer in Ikot Ekpene. Every morning, he wakes up early to feed his animals and check the crops. He uses a tractor to plough the land and a harvester during the harvest season. His children help him to carry produce home using wheelbarrows. Because of his dedication, Mr. Bassey's farm produces enough food for the whole family and others in the community.

4. Post-Listening Questions (Factual Recall)

1. Who is the main character in the story?
2. Where does Mr. Bassey live?
3. What are two things he does every morning?
4. What two *mechanized* tools does he use on his farm?
5. What *simple* tool do his children use?
6. Why is his farm so successful?

5. Evaluation (Inferential Questions)

1. What is listening comprehension?
2. What is the main *moral value* or *lesson* we can learn from Mr. Bassey's story?
3. Does Mr. Bassey practice *subsistence* farming (just for his family) or *commercial* farming (for sale)? How do you know? (Hint: The passage says he produces food for "others in the community.")
4. State two reasons why good listening skills are important in school.

6. Assignment

1. Listen to a short news broadcast on the radio or television tonight.
2. Write a three-sentence summary of the *main* news story you heard.
3. Write down two new words you heard, find their meanings, and write one sentence for each.

D. GRAMMAR

Topic: Noun Phrases with the Definite Article ("The")

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define a noun phrase and identify its components (head noun, pre-modifiers).
- Define the definite article ("the") and explain its function.
- List the rules for when to use "the."
- Identify and construct noun phrases using "the" in sentences.
- Identify the function of a noun phrase (as subject, object, or complement).

2. What is a Noun Phrase (NP)?

A noun is a single word (e.g., farmer, tractor).

A noun phrase is a group of words built around a noun that acts as a single unit. It is the noun plus all the words that describe it (modifiers).

The main noun is called the **head noun**.

- farmer (Head Noun)
- a farmer (Noun Phrase)
- the tall farmer (Noun Phrase)
- the hardworking farmer with the blue hat (A more complex Noun Phrase)

Structure: A noun phrase has a head noun and (optionally) modifiers before or after it.

PRE-MODIFIERS + HEAD NOUN + POST-MODIFIERS

- The + hardworking + **farmer** + in the field

3. The Definite Article: "The"

The word "the" is called the definite article. It is a determiner (a word that introduces a noun).

We use "the" when we are talking about a specific person, place, or thing that both the speaker and the listener know about.

"The" = You know which one I mean.

"A/An" = A general one, not a specific one.

- *Compare:*
 - "I need **a** hoe." (Any hoe will do.)
 - "I need **the** hoe." (The specific hoe that we both know about, maybe the one by the door.)

4. When to Use "The"

1. **Specific Mention:** When the item is specific and clear in the context.
 - *Example:* "Please pass me **the** cutlass." (We both see the cutlass).
 - *Example:* "**The** farmer is working." (We are talking about a specific farmer).
2. **Second Mention:** When you mention something for the *second time*.
 - *Example:* "I saw **a** tractor. **The** tractor was red."
3. **Unique Items:** When there is only one of something in the world or in our context.
 - *Example:* **The** sun, **the** moon, **the** sky, **the** internet, **the** principal (of our school).
4. **Superlatives:** Used with adjectives that show the most (e.g., -est, most).
 - *Example:* **The** tallest boy, **the** most hardworking farmer.
5. **With some Proper Nouns:** Used with names of rivers, oceans, and groups of countries.
 - *Example:* **The** River Niger, **The** Atlantic Ocean, **The** United Kingdom.

5. Functions of Noun Phrases

A noun phrase can do any job a single noun can do.

- **As Subject:** (Performs the action)
 - [**The hardworking farmer**] won a prize.
 - [**The old tractor in the shed**] is broken.

- **As Object:** (Receives the action)
 - The man repaired [**the broken plough**].
 - We saw [**the beautiful farm**].
- **As Complement:** (Follows a verb like "is," "was," "are" to rename or describe the subject)
 - My father is [**the manager**].
 - This is [**the best hoe for the job**].

6. Evaluation

1. Define a "noun phrase" and give an example.
2. What is the function of the definite article "the"?
3. Why do we say "**the** sun" but "**a** star"?
4. Identify the *entire* noun phrase in these sentences and state its function (Subject, Object, or Complement).
 - (a) The diligent girl swept the floor. (Identify both NPs)
 - (b) The strong man carried the heavy bag. (Identify both NPs)
 - (c) Mr. Bassey is the hardworking farmer.
5. Construct three sentences of your own using noun phrases that start with "the."

7. Assignment

1. Write five sentences, each containing a noun phrase that uses "the." Underline the *full* noun phrase in each sentence.
2. Expand each of the following single nouns into a complete noun phrase using "the" and at least one adjective.
 - (Example: *farmer* $\rightarrow$ *the old, wise farmer*)
 - (a) tractor
 - (b) house
 - (c) student
 - (d) river

- (e) teacher
3. Write one sentence where "the big, green tractor" is the **subject** and one sentence where it is the **object**.



WEEK 8

A. LISTENING COMPREHENSION

Topic: Grasping Main Ideas and Differentiating from Supporting Details

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define "main idea" and "supporting details" in the context of spoken language.
- Explain *why* identifying the main idea is the most crucial listening skill.
- Actively listen to a passage to extract its central point.
- Differentiate between the main idea and the examples or evidence used to support it.
- Verbally summarize the main idea of a spoken passage in one concise sentence.

2. Introduction to the Skill

Listening comprehension is the active process of receiving, interpreting, and understanding spoken messages. The single most important skill within this is **grasping the main idea**.

The **main idea** is the central, most important point the speaker is trying to make. It's the "big picture" or the "so what?" of the message.

Supporting details, on the other hand, are the specific pieces of information, examples, statistics, stories, or facts that are used to prove, explain, or illustrate the main idea.

Analogy: A Table

- The **Main Idea** is the flat **tabletop**. It's the one thing that holds everything together and provides the main surface.
- The **Supporting Details** are the **legs** of the table. They hold up the tabletop, giving it strength and proving its existence. You need the legs, but the *purpose* of the table is the tabletop.

3. Strategies for Identifying Main Ideas

To become an active listener, you must listen *for* something. Listen for these clues:

1. **Listen for the Topic Sentence:** In formal speeches or lectures, the main idea is often stated directly at the beginning (an introduction) or at the end (a summary).
2. **Listen for Repetition:** Speakers will often repeat key words, phrases, or concepts related to their main point. If you hear "The key issue is..." or "What's most important is...", pay attention.
3. **Listen for Signal Words:** Transition words can tell you what's important.
 - **Main Idea Signals:** *In summary, therefore, in conclusion, the point is, above all...*
 - **Supporting Detail Signals:** *For example, for instance, specifically, first, second, furthermore...*
4. **Listen to Tone and Emphasis:** A speaker's voice will often rise in volume or slow down when they are making their most important point.
5. **Summarize Mentally:** As you listen, constantly ask yourself, "What is the speaker *really* trying to tell me?" Try to rephrase the core message in your own head.

4. Practice Activity 1 (Teacher-led)

- **Passage (Read by Teacher):**

"Good citizens are essential for a nation to grow. A good citizen obeys the laws of the land, even when no one is watching. They also pay their taxes regularly and without complaint, knowing this money funds roads and hospitals. Furthermore, such a citizen respects the rights of others, shows kindness, and contributes to the progress of their local community. A nation can only be as strong as its citizens."

- **Discussion:**

- **Topic:** What is the general *subject*? (Answer: Good citizenship.)
- **Supporting Details:** What are some *examples* of good citizenship mentioned? (Answer: Obeying laws, paying taxes, respecting others.)
- **Main Idea:** What is the *one central point* the speaker is making about the topic? (Answer: Good citizens perform specific actions that are essential for national progress and strength.)

5. Practice Activity 2 (Class Exercise)

- **Passage (Read by Teacher):**

"Nigeria is blessed with vast natural resources. We have large deposits of crude oil and natural gas in the Niger Delta. In other regions, we have significant reserves of coal, limestone, tin, and iron ore. Our soil is fertile, and we have the capacity to be a world leader in agriculture. However, corruption and poor leadership have prevented these resources from benefiting the average citizen. Until we learn to manage this wealth wisely and elect honest leaders, true national development will remain slow."

- **Question:** What is the main idea of this passage?
 - *Option A (Supporting Detail):* Nigeria has oil, gas, and coal.
 - *Option B (Main Idea):* Nigeria's development is hindered by corruption and poor management, despite its great natural wealth.
 - *Option C (Too Vague):* Nigeria is a country in Africa.
- **Correct Answer:** B. Notice how 'A' is just one of the facts used to *support* the main argument 'B'.

6. Evaluation

1. Define listening comprehension in your own words.
2. What is the difference between a "main idea" and a "supporting detail"?
3. Mention three strategies you can use to identify the main idea of a speech.
4. (Teacher reads a new, short 3-4 sentence passage). Listen and write down the main idea in one sentence.
5. What is the relationship between "topic" and "main idea"?

7. Assignment

1. Listen to a 10-15 minute national news broadcast on the radio or television (e.g., NTA, Channels).

2. Identify three (3) main news stories reported. Write the main idea for each story in a single sentence.
 3. For *one* of those stories, list two (2) supporting details the newscaster provided to explain the main idea.
 4. Practice summarizing one of the stories to a family member in 20 words or less.
-

□ B. READING COMPREHENSION

Topic: Contextual Word Meaning (Using Context Clues)

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define "context" and "context clues."
- Explain *why* using context clues is a more efficient reading strategy than relying only on a dictionary.
- Identify and use at least four different types of context clues (Definition, Synonym, Antonym, Example, Inference).
- Accurately determine the meaning of an unfamiliar word from its use in a sentence.

2. Introduction

As a reader, what do you do when you see a word you don't know? Stopping to look up every word in a dictionary can be slow and interrupt your reading flow.

A more powerful skill is using **contextual word meaning**. This means figuring out a word's meaning by looking at the *clues* in the words, phrases, and sentences *surrounding* it. The "context" is the word's neighborhood, and it tells you a lot about the word.

3. Methods of Finding Meaning from Context (Types of Clues)

i. Definition (or Restatement) Clues

This is the easiest clue. The author directly defines the word in the sentence.

- **Signal Words:** *is, are, means, is called, which is, or, in other words, that is.*
- **Example 1:** "The **anthology**, which is a collection of poems, was on the desk."
 - *Meaning:* An anthology is a collection of poems.
- **Example 2:** "**Civics**, the study of citizens' rights and duties, is taught in schools."
 - *Meaning:* Civics is the study of citizens' rights and duties.

ii. Synonym (or Comparison) Clues

The author uses a similar word or phrase nearby to hint at the meaning.

- **Example 1:** "The teacher was **stern**, or very strict, with the students who came late."
 - *Meaning:* Stern means strict.
- **Example 2:** "He felt great **remorse**, or guilt, after cheating on the test."
 - *Meaning:* Remorse means guilt.

iii. Antonym (or Contrast) Clues

The author uses an opposite word or idea to help you figure out the meaning.

- **Signal Words:** *but, however, unlike, on the other hand, whereas.*
- **Example 1:** "Unlike his **generous** brother, Tunde is **stingy** with money."
 - *Meaning:* Generous must be the opposite of stingy (so, *willing to give*).
- **Example 2:** "Some students were **diligent**, but others were lazy and refused to work."
 - *Meaning:* Diligent must be the opposite of lazy (so, *hardworking*).

iv. Example (or Illustration) Clues

The author provides examples that help you understand the category the word belongs to.

- **Signal Words:** *such as, for example, for instance, including.*
- **Example 1:** "**Domestic animals**, such as goats, cows, and sheep, live near man."
 - *Meaning:* Domestic animals must mean animals that are tamed or live at home.

- **Example 2:** "He enjoys many **culinary** activities, for instance, cooking, baking, and grilling."
- *Meaning:* Culinary must be related to cooking or food.

v. Inference (or General Context) Clues

This is the most common, but most difficult, clue. The author doesn't give a direct hint; you must use the logic of the whole sentence (or paragraph) to figure out the meaning.

- **Example 1:** "When the old woman entered, everyone in the room stood up and greeted her **respectfully**."
- *Meaning:* Standing up for an elder is a polite action. Respectfully must mean *in a polite manner*.
- **Example 2:** "The car **careened** off the wet road, smashed through the barrier, and tumbled into the ditch."
- *Meaning:* The other actions (smashing, tumbling) are wild and uncontrolled. Careened must mean *to move wildly or swerve out of control*.

4. Practice Activity

Read the following passage and infer the meanings of the bolded words.

The new principal, Mr. Ade, was **meticulous** about punctuality. He checked the school gate himself at 7:31 AM, writing down the name of every latecomer. He believed that small habits built character. Though some teachers found his rules **stringent**, the results were impressive. In just one term, students became more disciplined, and the school's overall academic performance began to **escalate**.

- **Question 1:** What does **meticulous** mean? (Hint: Look at the *example* of his behavior.)
- *Answer:* Very careful, precise, or paying great attention to detail.
- **Question 2:** What does **stringent** mean? (Hint: The *inference* is that teachers found them hard to follow.)
- *Answer:* Very strict or severe.
- **Question 3:** What does **escalate** mean? (Hint: The *context* is "impressive results" and "more disciplined.")
- *Answer:* To increase, rise, or become greater.

5. Evaluation

1. Define "contextual meaning."
2. List and explain four different types of context clues, giving a new example for each.
3. Determine the meanings of the bolded words from their contexts:
 - a. The baby was very **fragile**, so we had to handle her gently and carefully.
 - b. His performance was **outstanding**; everyone in the audience praised him loudly.
 - c. He was **famished** after school, so he ate two large plates of rice.
4. In question 3a, what *type* of clue (Inference, Synonym, etc.) helped you understand "fragile"?
5. Why is using context clues a better skill for a reader than *only* using a dictionary?

6. Assignment

1. Choose a short news article (about 3-4 paragraphs) from a reputable newspaper (e.g., *The Guardian*, *ThisDay*, *Punch*).
2. Read the article and identify five (5) words that are new or challenging to you.
3. Create a table in your notebook with four columns.
4. Fill out the table:

Unfamiliar Word	My Guess (from Context)	What Clue(s) Did I Use?	Dictionary Definition
(e.g., stringent)	(e.g., very strict)	(e.g., Inference)	(e.g., (of regulations) strict, precise, and exacting.)

4 C. CONTINUOUS WRITING

Topic: Narrative Composition – "The Story of the Governor Who Stole Millions from the State Treasury"

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define narrative composition and its key elements.
- Understand the purpose of this specific topic: to explore themes of honesty, integrity, and accountability (National Values).
- Develop a structured plot for a story (Introduction, Rising Action, Climax, Resolution).
- Create believable characters and a vivid setting.
- Write a complete narrative that concludes with a clear moral lesson.

2. Introduction

A **narrative composition** tells a story. This story can be real (non-fiction) or imagined (fiction). Its purpose is to engage, entertain, and often, to teach a lesson.

Today's topic is not just a random story. It is an exploration of **National Values** such as **Honesty**, **Integrity**, and **Accountability**. Your story should show the *consequences* of corruption and the *importance* of honesty in public service.

3. Key Features of a Good Narrative

1. **Plot:** The sequence of events. What happens first, next, and last? It must have:
 - **Introduction (Exposition):** Introduce characters and setting.
 - **Rising Action:** The problem or conflict begins and gets worse.
 - **Climax:** The most exciting point! The "turning point" (e.g., the governor is caught).
 - **Falling Action:** The immediate results of the climax (e.g., the trial).
 - **Resolution:** The story ends, and the problem is solved (e.g., the governor is jailed, and the people learn a lesson).

2. **Characters:** The people in the story. Give them names and personalities (e.g., Governor Balogun, a brave journalist named Amina, a worried citizen).
3. **Setting:** The time and place (e.g., the lavish Government House, a poor-quality hospital, a tense courtroom).
4. **Point of View:** Who is telling the story?
 - *First Person:* "I saw the governor..." (Told by a witness).
 - *Third Person:* "Governor Balogun did..." (Told by an all-knowing narrator).
 - **(Third person is recommended for this topic.)**
5. **Moral Lesson (Theme):** The underlying message. (e.g., "Corruption leads to downfall," "Honesty is the best policy," "The truth will always come out.")

4. Writing Tips & Vocabulary Bank

- **Show, Don't Tell:**
 - *Telling:* "The governor was corrupt."
 - *Showing:* "While the state's hospitals had no medicine, Governor Balogun's children flew to London for a common cold."
 - *Telling:* "The roads were bad."
 - *Showing:* "Cars swerved and bounced, navigating potholes as large as basins, turning a 10-minute drive into an hour-long ordeal."
- **Use Past Tense:** *He stole, they discovered, he was arrested.*
- **Use Linking Words:** *At first, As time passed, Suddenly, Eventually, Finally.*

Vocabulary Bank			
Embezzlement	Misappropriation	Accountability	Lavish/Decadent
Investigative (journalist)	Corrupt	Poverty-stricken	Dilapidated
Scandal	Regime	Legacy	Justice

5. Sample Outline (To guide your writing)

- **Title:** The Golden Handshake that Became a Steel Shackle
- **Introduction:**
 - Introduce Governor Chief Balogun. He is newly elected, popular, and charismatic.
 - He gives a powerful speech promising "an era of prosperity" and an end to "the sins of the past."
 - The people of the state are hopeful.
- **Rising Action:**
 - Years pass. The "prosperity" is only for the governor and his friends (his **coterie**).
 - "Show, Don't Tell": Describe a **dilapidated** school or hospital.
 - Contrast this with the governor's **lavish** lifestyle (new jets, mansions abroad).
 - A young, **investigative** journalist, Amina, starts asking questions about a "State Infrastructure Fund" that seems to have vanished.
- **Climax:**
 - Amina gets a tip from a whistle-blower inside the government.
 - She receives bank documents showing a **misappropriation** of 500 million Naira, all leading to the governor's private account.
 - Her newspaper publishes the story. The EFCC (Economic and Financial Crimes Commission) raids the Governor's office.
- **Falling Action:**
 - The governor is arrested. His **impeachment** (removal from office) is swift.
 - The trial is long, but the evidence is undeniable.
- **Conclusion (Resolution):**
 - The governor is found guilty and sentenced to prison.
 - **Moral Lesson:** The people of the state, though disappointed, learn a valuable lesson about **accountability** and the power of a free press. They vow to be more vigilant in the future, knowing that a leader's true **legacy** is not in wealth, but in integrity.

6. Evaluation

1. Define narrative composition.

2. List the five key elements of a narrative plot in their correct order.
3. Why is "Show, Don't Tell" a more effective technique than "Telling"?
4. What is the main *purpose* or moral lesson of writing a story on this specific topic?
5. What point of view (1st or 3rd person) would be most effective for this story, and why?

7. Assignment

1. Using the outline and tips above, write your own story titled "**The Dishonest Accountant.**"
 2. Your story should be about 300-350 words.
 3. Focus on a company accountant who is stealing money from his boss.
 4. Ensure your story has a clear climax (e.g., how he gets caught) and a strong moral lesson at the end.
-

D. GRAMMAR

Topic: Noun Phrases with the Definite Article ("The") – Exceptions and Special Cases

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Recall the primary function of the definite article "the."
- Identify at least five categories of nouns that *do not* typically use "the."
- Explain the difference in meaning between "in prison" and "in *the* prison."
- Correctly use and omit "the" in sentences involving geographical names, institutions, and abstract concepts.

2. Recall: The Definite Article "The"

As we learned, "**the**" is the **definite article**. We use it to refer to a *specific* noun that both the speaker and listener know about.

- *Example:* "**The** teacher (our specific teacher) entered **the** class (our specific class)."

3. Exceptions: When NOT to Use "The" (Zero Article)

While "the" is common, it is *incorrectly* used in many situations. Here are the rules for when to *omit* it.

1. Diseases

We do not use "the" before the names of most diseases.

- **Wrong:** The malaria is dangerous.
- **Correct:** **Malaria** is dangerous.
- **Wrong:** He is suffering from the typhoid.
- **Correct:** He is suffering from **typhoid**.
- **Exception:** For *plural-sounding* diseases or *specific outbreaks*, we use "the."
 - *Example:* He had **the measles** / **the mumps**.
 - *Example:* **The malaria outbreak** in Kano was severe. (Here, "outbreak" is the main noun).

2. Geographical Names (Mountains, Lakes, Continents)

We do not use "the" before the names of *single* mountains, *single* lakes, or continents.

- **Wrong:** The Mount Everest is high.
- **Correct:** **Mount Everest** is high.
- **Wrong:** The Lake Chad is drying up.
- **Correct:** **Lake Chad** is drying up.
- **Wrong:** He visited the Africa.
- **Correct:** He visited **Africa**.
- **Exception:** We *do* use "the" for **Mountain Ranges, Groups of Lakes, and Archipelagos** (groups of islands).
 - *Example:* **The Alps, The Himalayas** (Ranges)
 - *Example:* **The Great Lakes** (Group)
 - *Example:* **The Philippines, The West Indies** (Groups of islands)

3. Institutions (for their primary purpose)

We omit "the" when we talk about the *purpose* or *idea* of an institution, not the physical building.

- **Examples:**

- "He is at **school**." (Meaning: He is *studying* as a student.)
- "She went to **church** on Sunday." (Meaning: She went to *worship*.)
- "My father is in **prison**." (Meaning: He is *a prisoner*.)
- "She is in **hospital**." (Meaning: She is *a patient*.)
- "He went to **bed**." (Meaning: He went to *sleep*.)
- **When we DO use "the":** We use "the" when we mean the specific *building or object*.
 - "He went to **the school** to paint it." (He is a painter, not a student.)
 - "She visited **the church** to admire its design." (She is a tourist, not a worshipper.)
 - "The governor visited **the prison**." (He is a visitor, not a prisoner.)
 - "I sat on **the bed**." (Referring to the piece of furniture.)

4. Countries

Generally, we do not use "the" before names of *most* countries.

- **Correct: Nigeria, Ghana, Canada, France, China.**
- **Exception:** We use "the" for countries with *plural* names or names that are *descriptive* (containing "States," "Kingdom," "Republic").
 - **Plural: The Netherlands, The Philippines**
 - **Descriptive: The United States (USA), The United Kingdom (UK), The Federal Republic of Nigeria, The People's Republic of China.**

5. Meals, Languages, and Subjects

We do not use "the" for general meals, languages, or academic subjects.

- **Meals:** "We had **breakfast** at 8 a.m." (Not: *The breakfast*)
- **Languages:** "She speaks **English** fluently." (Not: *The English*)
- **Subjects:** "**Mathematics** is my best subject." (Not: *The Mathematics*)

4. Evaluation

1. What is the main function of the definite article "the"?
2. List five categories of nouns where "the" is usually *omitted*.
3. Explain the difference in meaning between these two sentences:
 - (a) "The politician is in prison."
 - (b) "The journalist is in the prison."
4. Correct the errors in the following sentences (some may be correct):
 - a. The malaria kills many people every year.
 - b. We climbed the Mount Kilimanjaro on our trip.
 - c. He plays the football every weekend.
 - d. The students went to the bed late.
 - e. She is studying the history of the United States.
5. Write two correct sentences: one for a country that uses "the" and one for a country that does not.

5. Assignment

1. Write a short paragraph (about 5-7 sentences) describing your daily routine. You must include the words: **breakfast**, **school**, **lunch**, and **bed**. Pay close attention to *not* using "the" with them.
2. Write a short paragraph (about 5-7 sentences) describing your home country, **Nigeria**. You must correctly use (or omit) "the" when talking about its geography (e.g., rivers, mountains) and its official name.
3. Underline all noun phrases in both paragraphs.

WEEK 9

A. SPOKEN ENGLISH (ORAL ENGLISH)

Topic: Oral Composition Skills II (Descriptive)

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define descriptive oral composition.
- Differentiate a descriptive composition from a narrative one.
- Identify and use the key strategies for effective oral description (sensory details, vivid language, logical ordering).
- Understand and demonstrate how voice (pace, tone, volume, pause) enhances an oral description.
- Orally describe a person, place, or object clearly and vividly.

2. Introduction

Descriptive oral composition is the art of "painting a picture" using spoken words. The goal is to make your listener *see, hear, feel, smell, and taste* what you are describing.

- **Narrative (Week 4) vs. Descriptive (Week 9):**
 - A **narrative** tells a story (what *happened*). It focuses on **action** and **time** (e.g., "A Day I Will Never Forget").
 - A **descriptive** composition paints a picture (what something *is like*). It focuses on **details** and **senses** (e.g., "My Classroom").

In an *oral* description, your **voice** is your paintbrush. How you speak is just as important as the words you choose.

3. Key Strategies for a Good Descriptive Oral Composition

i. Use of Sensory Details (The 5 Senses)

Your description is only effective if it makes the listener use their imagination.

| Sense | Questions to Ask | Example Words |

| :--- | :--- | :--- |

| Sight | What does it look like? (Colour, shape, size, light) | gleaming, dull, massive, snake-like, shadowy, vibrant |

| Sound | What does it sound like? (Loud, soft, music, noise) | whispering, rumbling, screeching, buzzing, silent, melodious |

| Smell | What does it smell like? (Pleasant, bad, strong, faint) | acrid, fragrant, damp, fresh-baked, rotten, smoky |

| Touch | What does it feel like? (Temperature, texture) | rough, slimy, sharp, velvety, icy, oppressive (heat) |

| Taste | What does it taste like? (Sweet, sour, etc.) | bitter, zesty, salty, bland, spicy, delicious |

ii. Use Specific Details (Vivid Language)

Avoid vague, general words. Be precise.

- **Vague:** "There was a *nice tree* in the *big* compound."
- **Vivid:** "A *massive, ancient Iroko tree*, with a *gnarled, twisted trunk*, stood in the *centre* of the *dusty, sun-baked* compound."
- **Vague:** "The market was *loud*."
- **Vivid:** "The market *buzzed* with the *shouts of traders bargaining*, the *screeching of wheelbarrows*, and the *blaring of a nearby speaker*."

iii. Logical Ordering

Organize your description so the listener isn't confused.

- **Spatial Order:** Describe from top-to-bottom, left-to-right, or near-to-far. (e.g., "As you enter the classroom, you first see... then at the back...")
- **Order of Importance:** Start with the most noticeable feature. (e.g., "The first thing you notice about my uncle is his booming, loud laugh...")

iv. Effective Use of Voice (The "Oral" Part)

This is what makes it an *oral* composition.

- **Pace:** Speak slowly when describing something calm or sad. Speak faster for excitement or chaos.
- **Tone:** Let your voice show emotion. If you describe a sad scene, sound sad. If you describe an exciting one, sound excited.
- **Volume:** Get louder to describe a storm or a shout. Get softer (whisper) to describe a secret or a quiet morning.
- **Pause:** Pause for a second after describing an important detail. This gives the listener time to "see" it in their mind.

4. Class Activity: Picture Description

- **Topic:** A Busy Fish Market
- **Oral Description Example:**

(Speaks clearly, with an engaged tone)

"In the picture, the first thing I see is chaos and colour. The market is crowded with people, mostly women in brightly-coloured wrappers. They are bent over large, silver-grey baskets overflowing with gleaming, fresh fish. Some fish are massive, like the catfish, while others are tiny, shiny Bonga fish. The ground is wet and muddy, and you can almost smell the sharp, salty scent of the sea mixed with the smoky aroma of a nearby fire. In the background, young boys shout as they carry trays on their heads, while customers bargain loudly, their voices rising and falling in a constant hum."

5. Evaluation

1. What is the main difference between a descriptive oral composition and a narrative oral composition?
2. Mention four key strategies for a good description.
3. Why is "Use of Voice" (pace, tone, etc.) essential in *oral* description?
4. (Oral Test) Stand up and give a one-minute oral description of one of these:
 - The person sitting next to you.
 - This classroom.
 - A rainy day.
5. What is "sensory detail"? Give two examples of details that appeal to *sound* and *smell*.

6. Assignment

1. Prepare a 2-minute oral description of "**My Favourite Place to Eat.**" (This could be your dining room, a local restaurant, or a stall).
 2. Focus on using all five senses in your description.
 3. **Practice:** Record yourself on a phone. Listen back and ask:
 - Did I use vivid words?
 - Did I sound bored (a monotone voice) or interested?
 - Did I use pauses to let my listener imagine the scene?
 4. Write down five (5) of the best sensory adjectives you used (e.g., spicy, sizzling, crowded).
-

🐟 B. VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT

Topic: Vocabulary Associated with Fishing

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define fishing and its importance in Nigeria.
- Identify and understand at least 15 vocabulary items related to fishing.
- Categorize fishing vocabulary into logical groups (tools, actions, places).
- Use this new vocabulary correctly in sentences.

2. Introduction

Fishing is the activity of catching fish, either for food or as a business. In Nigeria, with its long coastline (Atlantic Ocean) and major rivers (Niger, Benue), fishing is a vital part of the economy and culture, especially in riverine and coastal states.

This activity has its own special set of words.

3. Categorized Fishing Vocabulary

We can group the words to make them easier to learn.

i. Equipment & Gear (The Tools)

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Net	A device made of woven mesh (threads) used to trap fish.	The fishermen cast their nets into the lagoon at dawn.
Hook	A curved, sharp piece of metal used to catch a fish by its mouth.	He carefully placed the worm on the hook .
Line	The strong thread used to attach a hook.	The line snapped just as he was pulling the fish in.
Sinker	A small piece of lead (a weight) used to make	Without a sinker , his bait stayed

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
	the hook and line sink.	on the surface.
Bait	Food (like a worm, small fish, or	
Canoe	A small, narrow, light boat, pointed at both ends, moved with a paddle.	Three fishermen paddled the canoe down the river.
Trawler	A large, commercial fishing boat that uses a	
Trap	A cage or basket (like a <i>Fadong</i>) used to catch fish alive.	They set the trap near the riverbank.
Tackle	The general term for all equipment used for fishing (hooks, lines, sinkers, etc.).	He kept his tackle in a small wooden box.

ii. People, Actions & Concepts

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Fisherman	A person who catches fish for a living or as a hobby.	The fisherman mended his nets on the beach.

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Catch (noun)	The total amount of fish caught at one time.	The day's catch was small because of the storm.
To Cast (verb)	To throw a hook or a net into the water.	He cast his line into the middle of the stream.
To Haul (verb)	To pull in something heavy (like a full net).	It took four men to haul the net onto the boat.
Fish Pond	An artificial, human-made pond used for aquaculture (fish farming).	He is raising catfish in his new fish pond .
Aquaculture	The farming of fish, crustaceans, etc.; also known as fish farming.	Aquaculture is a growing business in Nigeria.
This is bait (food) to attract the fish.		

4. Practice: Fill in the Blanks

Use the correct words from the vocabulary list to complete this passage:

Ebi is a (1) _____ in his village. Every morning, he takes his (2) _____ and paddles out to the river. He doesn't use a large (3) _____ like the big ships. Instead, he uses a (4) _____ and (5), *hoping to get a bite. He puts an earthworm on his (6) as (7). By noon, his (8) is usually large enough to sell at the market.*

(Answers: 1. fisherman, 2. canoe, 3. trawler, 4. line, 5. sinker, 6. hook, 7. bait, 8. catch)

5. Evaluation

1. Define "fishing" in one sentence.
2. What is the difference between a **canoe** and a **trawler**?
3. Explain the function of these three items: (a) **bait**, (b) **hook**, (c) **sinker**.
4. What is **aquaculture**?
5. Use the words **catch** (noun) and **to haul** (verb) in two separate, correct sentences.

6. Assignment

1. Draw and label five different fishing implements (e.g., net, hook, canoe, trap, line and sinker).
 2. Write a short descriptive paragraph (about 100 words) titled "A Fisherman at Work." You must use at least six (6) words from the vocabulary list.
 3. Ask your family if they know any local names for fishing traps or nets and write them down.
-

4 C. CONTINUOUS WRITING

Topic: Descriptive Composition – "The Petrol Station in Times of Fuel Scarcity"

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Understand the features of a descriptive composition.
- Apply sensory details to describe a specific, high-emotion situation.
- Establish and maintain a "dominant mood" (e.g., frustration, chaos) through words.
- Use figurative language (similes, metaphors) to make the description more powerful.
- Write a well-structured descriptive essay on the given topic.

2. Introduction

A descriptive composition "paints a picture with words." Your goal for this topic is to make your reader *feel* the heat, the frustration, and the chaos of a fuel scarcity. You are not just telling a story (narrative); you are describing a *scene*.

The key to this essay is capturing the **dominant mood**—the feeling of **frustration, anger, and desperation**.

3. Building Your Description: A Sensory Bank

Let's brainstorm words *before* we write.

Sense	Details for a Fuel Scarcity Scene
Sight	long, snake-like queues of cars; <i>flashing</i> "EMPTY" lights on dashboards; <i>sweat-stained</i> shirts; <i>anxious</i> faces; <i>flashing</i> fuel gauges; <i>jerry cans</i> of all colours; <i>waving</i> of money by black-market sellers.
Sound	<i>angry, impatient</i> car horns; the <i>shouting</i> of drivers; the <i>rumble</i> of engines; the <i>sputtering</i> of a generator dying; "Oga, e don finish!"
Smell	the <i>acrid, sharp</i> smell of petrol fumes; the <i>choking</i> smell of exhaust; the <i>hot, dusty</i> air.
Touch	the <i>oppressive, suffocating</i> heat; the <i>sticky, humid</i> air; the <i>hard</i> plastic of a jerry can; the <i>sweat</i> trickling down your back.
Mood	Frustration, Anger, Chaos, Desperation, Exhaustion, Irony.

4. Using Figurative Language

This makes your description powerful.

- **Simile (like/as):** "The queue of cars stretched *like* a wounded serpent down the road."
- **Metaphor (is/are):** "The small, yellow jerry can *was* liquid gold."
- **Personification:** "The sun *beat down* on us *relentlessly*, showing no mercy."
- **Hyperbole (Exaggeration):** "We waited in the line for an *eternity*."

5. Sample Composition (Expanded)

Title: The Petrol State in Times of Fuel Scarcity

It was only 6 a.m. in the oil-rich city of Port Harcourt, but the chaos had already begun. The sun was not yet high, but the **oppressive heat** was already rising, mixing with the **acrid smell of petrol fumes**. The streets were not just crowded; they were blocked. A long, **snake-like queue** of cars, motorcycles, and tricycles stretched from the "NNPC" sign, twisting around the corner and disappearing down the highway.

Drivers, with **sweat-staining** their shirts, sat impatiently on their car bonnets, fanning themselves with old newspapers. Others argued, their **voices rising** in anger over the new, unofficial pump price. "How can it be 1,000 Naira?" one man yelled, his face a mask of disbelief. The **noise was a symphony of chaos**: the *impatient blaring of horns*, the *shouts* of black-market sellers waving small, dirty jerry cans, and the *sputtering* of an engine as it finally ran dry.

The **irony** was the most painful part. Here we were, in a state that sits on a sea of crude oil, yet we were suffering, begging for a few litres of petrol. A billboard above the station showed a smiling politician promising "The Good Life." The people below were not smiling. By evening, I watched a man, his face *streaked with grime and exhaustion*, push his silent car home. He had no fuel. He had only frustration, a story of a rich land where the people were still poor.

6. Evaluation

1. What is the main purpose of a descriptive composition?
2. What is "dominant mood"? What is the dominant mood of the sample essay?
3. List two details from the sample essay that appeal to (a) **Sight** and (b) **Sound**.
4. Write one *simile* and one *metaphor* that could be used to describe a crowded petrol station.

5. What is the "irony" the writer mentions?

7. Assignment

1. Write a full descriptive essay (about 250-300 words) on the topic: "A Day at the Main Market During a Time of Scarcity."

(This could be scarcity of food, cash, or any commodity).

2. Focus on "showing, not telling." Use the Sensory Bank method to brainstorm your details first.
3. Underline at least two (2) similes or metaphors you use in your essay.
-

D. GRAMMAR

Topic: Nominalization of Adjectives

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define nominalization.
- Explain the *purpose* of nominalization (e.g., for formal writing).
- Identify the common suffixes used to nominalize adjectives (e.g., -ness, -ity, -ce).
- Convert adjectives into their noun forms.
- Rewrite informal sentences as formal sentences using nominalized adjectives.

2. Introduction

Nominalization (or "nouncing") is the process of turning a word that is *not* a noun (like an adjective or a verb) into a **noun**.

- **Adjective:** honest (describes a person)
- **Noun:** honesty (the *concept* or *quality* of being honest)

Why do we do this?

Nominalization makes our writing sound more formal, academic, and objective. It allows us to talk about concepts and ideas rather than just people and actions.

- **Informal (Adjective):** "The minister was *wise*, so the king trusted him."
- **Formal (Noun):** "The minister's *wisdom* earned him the king's trust."

3. Formation of Nouns from Adjectives (How-To)

We usually form these nouns by adding a **suffix** (an ending).

Rule 1: Adding -ness

(Used for many common adjectives to show a state or quality)

- happy $\rightarrow$ **happiness**
- kind $\rightarrow$ **kindness**
- sad $\rightarrow$ **sadness**
- weak $\rightarrow$ **weakness**
- good $\rightarrow$ **goodness**

Rule 2: Adding -ity or -ty

(Often used for Latin-based adjectives)

- able $\rightarrow$ **ability**
- pure $\rightarrow$ **purity**
- formal $\rightarrow$ **formality**
- generous $\rightarrow$ **generosity**
- difficult $\rightarrow$ **difficulty**
- stupid $\rightarrow$ **stupidity**

Rule 3: Adding -ance or -ence

- important $\rightarrow$ **importance**
- arrogant $\rightarrow$ **arrogance**

- ignorant $\rightarrow$ **ignorance**
- patient $\rightarrow$ **patience**
- innocent $\rightarrow$ **innocence**

Rule 4: Irregular / Stem Change

(These are common and must be memorized)

- strong $\rightarrow$ **strength**
- long $\rightarrow$ **length**
- wide $\rightarrow$ **width**
- high $\rightarrow$ **height**
- deep $\rightarrow$ **depth**
- true $\rightarrow$ **truth**
- brave $\rightarrow$ **bravery**
- hot $\rightarrow$ **heat**
- poor $\rightarrow$ **poverty**

4. Sentence Examples (Showing the Function)

1. *Adjective:* The soldiers were **brave**.
 - *Noun:* The soldiers showed great **bravery**.
2. *Adjective:* The room is **wide**.
 - *Noun:* What is the **width** of the room?
3. *Adjective:* It is **important** to be on time.
 - *Noun:* Punctuality is of great **importance**.
4. *Adjective:* She is very **honest**.
 - *Noun:* Her **honesty** is her best quality.

5. Evaluation

1. Define nominalization in your own words.
2. Give one reason why we use nominalization in writing.

3. Form the correct nouns from these adjectives:
 - (a) happy
 - (b) long
 - (c) innocent
 - (d) generous
 - (e) strong
4. Change the following *informal* sentence into a *formal* one using nominalization:
 - **Informal:** "He was very ambitious, and this made him work hard."
 - **Formal:** "His..."
5. Use the noun forms of "**pure**" and "**wise**" in two separate, correct sentences.

6. Assignment

1. Create a table with two columns (Adjective, Noun). Find and list ten new pairs of adjectives and their noun forms (e.g., proud $\rightarrow$ pride).
2. Rewrite the following sentences to make them more formal by using nominalization.
 - a. The child was very curious, so he opened the box.
 - b. Because she was kind, everyone loved her.
 - c. The water is deep, so it is dangerous.
3. Write a short paragraph (3-4 sentences) on the topic "The Qualities of a Good Leader," using at least three nominalized words (e.g., honesty, strength, wisdom).

WEEK 10

A. LISTENING COMPREHENSION

Topic: Grasping Main Points

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define "main point" in the context of listening.
- Differentiate between a main point and a supporting detail.
- Identify signal words that introduce main points.
- Actively listen to a passage and extract its key messages.
- Summarize the main points of a spoken text in your own words.

2. Introduction

Listening comprehension is not just about *hearing* sounds; it is an *active* mental process of *understanding* and *interpreting* spoken information.

One of the most important skills in active listening is grasping the **main points**. Think of yourself as a detective. You are not just collecting all the sand (every single word); you are looking for the gold nuggets (the key ideas). The main points are the speaker's primary messages—the "big ideas" they want you to leave with.

3. Skills for Identifying Main Points

To find the "gold nuggets" (main points), you need the right tools (skills):

- **Active Concentration:** You must consciously decide to focus. This means ignoring distractions, not thinking about your reply, and focusing only on the speaker's message.

- **Prediction:** As you listen, your brain should be thinking ahead. "Based on the title, what will they talk about?" "They just said 'firstly,' so I expect a 'secondly'."
- **Identifying Signal Words (Signposts):** Speakers use "signposts" to guide you. Listen for these:
 - **To introduce a big idea:** "My main point is...", "The most important thing...", "What this all means is..."
 - **To list points:** "First," "Second," "Next," "Finally..."
 - **To conclude:** "In conclusion," "Therefore," "To summarize..."
 - **To show contrast (and a new idea):** "However," "But," "On the other hand..."
- **Note-Taking (Keywords only):** Do not try to write full sentences. This is the biggest mistake. You will stop *listening* and start *writing*. Instead, jot down only **keywords** and **phrases** that capture the idea.
- **Mental Summarization:** After the speaker finishes a section, ask yourself, "In one short sentence, what was the *one* thing they just said?"

4. Main Point vs. Supporting Detail

This is the most crucial distinction.

- **Main Point (The Tabletop):** This is the core idea. It's the general statement.
- **Supporting Details (The Legs):** These *prove* or *explain* the main point. They are the examples, statistics, stories, or facts.

Example:

- **Main Point:** Nigeria's film industry, Nollywood, is globally recognized.
- **Supporting Detail:** It is the second-largest film producer by volume in the world.
- **Supporting Detail:** Its movies are popular across Africa, the Caribbean, and Europe.

You need the details to understand the main point, but the main point is the *message*.

5. Class Activity

Your teacher will read the following passage to you twice. Listen carefully. Do not write during the first reading. During the second reading, jot down keywords.

Passage:

"Good morning, students. Today, I want to talk about a serious challenge: youth unemployment. Many young, educated people today face serious difficulties in finding work after graduation. This situation creates several problems. First, without jobs, they are often forced to depend on their parents or relatives for many years, which can be frustrating. Second, some may even engage in crime out of frustration or desperation. To solve this, we cannot rely on the government alone. The government must, however, encourage small-scale businesses through loans. More importantly, it must heavily promote skill acquisition programs, so that you don't just have a certificate, but a skill."

Analysis:

- **Topic:** Youth Unemployment
- **Main Point 1:** Youth unemployment is a major problem for graduates.
- **Main Point 2:** It leads to negative social effects (like dependence and crime).
- **Main Point 3:** The solution requires government to support small businesses and skill training.

(Notice: "frustrating" is a supporting detail. "Loans" is a supporting detail. The main points are the big ideas.)

6. Evaluation

1. What is the difference between *hearing* and *listening* comprehension?
2. In your own words, what is a "main point"?
3. What is a "supporting detail"? Give one example.
4. Mention three signal words and what they tell a listener.
5. What is the *wrong* way to take notes while listening?
6. (Your teacher will read a new short passage). Listen and write down the two main points.

7. Assignment

1. Listen to a 5-10 minute national news broadcast on the radio or TV tonight.

2. Write down what you think the **three main news stories** (the main points) were.
 3. For *one* of those stories, write down two *supporting details* you heard.
 4. List three challenges in your own home or environment that make effective listening difficult (e.g., "noise from the generator," "my siblings talking").
-

❏ B. READING COMPREHENSION

Topic: Comprehending Main Ideas

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define "main idea" in a written text.
- Differentiate between the *topic* and the *main idea*.
- Locate the "topic sentence" in a paragraph.
- Summarize the main idea of a passage in a single, clear sentence.

2. Introduction

Reading comprehension is the ability to *understand* what you read. Just like in listening, the most important skill is to find the **main idea**.

What's the difference between reading and listening for a main idea? In reading, you have a huge advantage: **you can go back**. You can re-read, pause, and think. The writer often leaves clear clues.

3. Topic vs. Main Idea

This is a very important difference.

- **Topic:** The *subject* of the passage. It's a short word or phrase (e.g., "Corruption," "Football," "HIV/AIDS").

- **Main Idea:** The *point* the writer is making *about* the topic. It's a full sentence (e.g., "Corruption is Nigeria's biggest problem," "HIV/AIDS can be prevented.").

4. How to Find the Main Idea

1. **Skim the Passage:** Read the first and last sentences of each paragraph. Look at the title. This gives you the *topic*.
2. **Identify the Topic Sentence:** In most paragraphs, the writer states the main idea directly in one sentence. This is the **topic sentence**. It's often the *first* sentence, but it can also be the *last* (as a summary).
3. **Distinguish Key Ideas from Supporting Details:** Ask yourself, "Does this sentence *explain* another sentence, or is it the *main point*?"
 - Lagos is crowded. (Main Idea)
 - It has over 20 million people. (Supporting Detail)
 - The traffic is terrible. (Supporting Detail)
4. **Summarize in Your Own Words:** After reading, ask, "What is the *one thing* the author wants me to know?" If you can say it in one sentence, you have found the main idea.

5. Sample Passage 1 (Topical Issue: Corruption)

Corruption has become one of the greatest problems facing many developing countries. It involves the misuse of public office for personal gain. Bribery, embezzlement, and nepotism are common forms of corruption. In Nigeria, **corruption** affects every sector—from education to health, and even the police. It leads to poverty, poor infrastructure, and a total loss of trust in leadership. To reduce **corruption**, there must be transparency, accountability, and severe punishment for offenders.

- **Topic:** Corruption.
- **Main Idea:** Corruption is a serious national problem that causes poverty and underdevelopment, and it must be fought through transparency and accountability.
- **Topic Sentence (clue):** The very first sentence.

6. Practice Passage 2 (HIV/AIDS Awareness)

HIV/AIDS remains a global health challenge. The disease spreads mainly through unprotected sex, sharing infected needles, and from an infected mother to her child during birth. Education, safe practices, and regular testing are essential to prevention. In many African communities, ignorance and stigma make it difficult for people to seek help. People are afraid to get tested because they fear their families and friends will reject them. However, with awareness campaigns and proper medical support, the disease can be controlled and managed effectively, allowing people to live long, productive lives.

- **Topic:** HIV/AIDS.
- **Main Idea:** (Find it yourself... what is the *one point* the author is making?)
 - *Possible Answer:* HIV/AIDS is a serious disease, but it can be prevented and managed through education, awareness, and medical care (despite the challenges of stigma).

7. Evaluation

1. What is the main idea in a reading passage?
2. What is the difference between a *topic* and a *main idea*?
3. What is a "topic sentence," and where is it usually found?
4. From Sample Passage 1, list two *supporting details* that explain *how* corruption affects Nigeria.
5. From Practice Passage 2, what is the *one* main idea? Write it in a single sentence.

8. Assignment

1. Find a short article (one or two paragraphs) in a newspaper or online about **environmental pollution**.
2. Read it and identify:
 - (a) The Topic
 - (b) The Main Idea (in one sentence)
 - (c) Two (2) supporting details.
3. Paste the article (or write it out) in your notebook, and write your answers (a, b, c) below it.

✦ C. CONTINUOUS WRITING

Topic: Descriptive Composition – "A Flood Disaster Caused by Blocked Drains"

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define a descriptive composition.
- Understand the importance of appealing to the five senses.
- Use vivid adjectives, adverbs, and figurative language (similes, metaphors).
- Organize a descriptive essay logically.
- Write a powerful description of a flood scene.

2. Introduction

A **descriptive composition** "paints a picture with words." Your goal is not to tell a *story* (narrative), but to make your reader *experience* a moment. You want them to *see, hear, smell, touch, and feel* the scene.

Today's topic, "A Flood Disaster Caused by Blocked Drains," is powerful. It's not just about "water"; it's about *dirty* water, *chaos, fear*, and the *smell* of refuse. Your main challenge is to **Show, Don't Tell.**

- **Telling:** "The flood was bad." (Boring)
- **Showing:** "Oily, black water gurgled up from the gutters, carrying a tide of plastic bottles and filth into our homes." (Vivid)

3. Brainstorming: The Sensory Bank

Before you write, fill your "sensory bank." How did the flood appeal to the senses?

- **SIGHT (What did you see?):**

- Oily, brown, black water
- Floating plastic bottles, nylon bags, old shoes
- Half-submerged cars and tricycles (Keke)
- People wading through water, holding their possessions high
- Furniture (chairs, mattresses) floating out of houses
- Panicked faces, children crying
- **SOUND (What did you hear?):**
 - The *pounding* of the heavy rain
 - The *gurgling* of water from the blocked drains
 - *Shouts* and *screams* of people
 - The *splash* as something heavy fell
 - The *rumble* of thunder
- **SMELL (What did you smell?):**
 - The overwhelming *stench* of raw sewage
 - The *smell* of wet mud and garbage
 - The *damp, musty* smell of soaked property
- **TOUCH (What did you feel?):**
 - The *icy, cold* water
 - The *slimy* mud underfoot
 - The *pelting* rain on your skin
- **MOOD (The overall feeling):**
 - Fear, panic, chaos, despair, anger.

4. Sample Composition (Expanded)

Title: The Day the Gutter Fought Back

It was a gloomy morning in late July. **Dark, menacing clouds** hung low over the city, choking the sky. Soon, the heavy rain began to fall, not as a shower, but as an **angry, pounding assault**.

Within an hour, our street had vanished. The drains, **choked with months of plastic bottles and refuse**, could not breathe. They began to vomit, turning the road into a **filthy, raging river**.

The **stench of sewage** and rotting garbage filled the air. I watched from our upstairs window as the **oily, brown water** swirled into homes and shops. A woman's high-pitched scream cut through the sound of the rain as her stall of vegetables was swept away. Cars stalled, their engines drowned, their horns silent. I saw a small, yellow tricycle (Keke) **half-submerged**, looking like a defeated animal.

Children screamed as their schoolbooks floated past. People ran in confusion, wading through the **waist-deep, murky water**, their faces masks of panic. When the rain finally stopped, the street was a junkyard. It was covered in **slimy debris**, broken furniture, and the evidence of our own carelessness. We blamed the government, but we also knew the truth: we had blocked the drains with our own hands, and now, we were paying the price.

5. Writing Tips

- **Start with the Setting:** Establish the scene (the clouds, the rain).
- **Use Strong Verbs:** "Vomited," "choked," "swirled," "pounded."
- **Use Figurative Language:**
 - *Simile:* "The street looked *like* a river."
 - *Metaphor:* "The street *was* a river."
 - *Personification:* "The drains *could not breathe*."
- **End with a Reflection:** End with a final, powerful image or thought.

6. Evaluation

1. What is the main purpose of a descriptive composition?
2. What does "Show, Don't Tell" mean? Give an example.
3. From the "Sensory Bank," list one detail for *sight*, *sound*, and *smell*.
4. Identify one example of *personification* from the sample composition.
5. What *mood* does the sample composition create?

7. Assignment

1. Write a descriptive essay on the topic, "**A Day at a Crowded Motor Park.**" (250-300 words)
 2. Focus on using all five senses to make the reader feel the *chaos*, *noise*, and *energy* of the park.
 3. Underline at least two (2) vivid adjectives and one (1) simile you use.
-

D. GRAMMAR

Topic: Nominalization of Verbs

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define "nominalization" of verbs.
- Explain *why* nominalization is used (e.g., for formal writing).
- Identify the common suffixes used to turn verbs into nouns (-tion, -ment, -al, etc.).
- Form nouns from common verbs.
- Use nominalized verbs correctly in sentences.

2. Introduction

Nominalization is a big word for a simple idea. It is the process of turning a word (like a verb or adjective) into a **noun**.

Today, we are looking at **Nominalization of Verbs**. This means we are turning an *action* or *process* (a verb) into a *thing* or *concept* (a noun).

- **Verb (Action):** He decided.
- **Noun (Concept):** His decision was final.

3. Why Use Nominalization?

We nominalize verbs for two main reasons:

1. **To sound more formal and academic:** It's common in textbooks, official reports, and academic essays.
 - *Informal:* "We need to *manage* the project better."
 - *Formal:* "Better *management* of the project is required."
2. **To make an action the *subject* of a sentence:** It allows us to talk *about* the action itself.
 - "**Growth** is important for the company." (from the verb *grow*)
 - "**Failure** is not an option." (from the verb *fail*)

4. Common Patterns for Nominalizing Verbs

Pattern	Verb	Noun (Nominalized Form)
Add -tion / -sion	act	action
	invite	invitation
	decide	decision
	inform	information
Add -ment	manage	management
	govern	government
	pay	payment
Add -al	arrive	arrival

Pattern	Verb	Noun (Nominalized Form)
	approve	approval
	deny	denial
Add -ance / -ence	perform	performance
	accept	acceptance
	resist	resistance
Spelling Change	choose	choice
(Irregular)	grow	growth
	fail	failure
	advise	advice (see note below)
	speak	speech
	conquer	conquest

5. Spotlight: advise vs. advice

This is a very common error in

SSCE.

- advise (with an 's') is the **VERB** (the action).
 - "I **advise** you to study."
- advice (with a 'c') is the **NOUN** (the concept).
 - "He gave me good **advice**."
 - (Note: advice is an uncountable noun. You cannot say "an advice." You say "a *piece* of advice.")

6. Evaluation

1. Define "nominalization of verbs" in your own words.
2. Give one reason why a writer would use nominalization.
3. Form nouns from the following verbs:
 - (a) invite
 - (b) grow
 - (c) fail
 - (d) approve
 - (e) act
4. Write one sentence for *each* word, correctly showing the difference between advise and advice.
5. Change this informal sentence to a formal one using nominalization: "We *failed* because we did not *prepare*."
 - Hint: "Our..."

7. Assignment

1. Create a table with two columns. List ten (10) new verbs and their nominalized forms (e.g., know $\rightarrow$ knowledge).
2. Write five (5) original sentences using any of the nominalized verbs from today's lesson (e.g., decision, growth, arrival, failure).
3. Write a short paragraph on the topic, "The Importance of Good Decision-Making," using at least three nominalized verbs (like decision, action, failure, growth).

WEEK 11

A. VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT

Topic: Vocabulary Associated with Animal Husbandry

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define "animal husbandry" and its relationship to agriculture.
- Identify and understand at least 20 words related to animal farming.
- Categorize vocabulary based on the type of animal or activity.
- Use this specialized vocabulary correctly in sentences.

2. Content: Introduction

Animal Husbandry is a vital branch of agriculture that involves the care, breeding, rearing, and management of domesticated animals. These animals are raised to provide us with food (meat, milk, eggs), materials (wool, leather), and services (transport, farm labour).

This field has a rich and specific vocabulary used to describe the animals, their homes, their health, and the processes involved in raising them.

3. Key Vocabulary and Meanings

We can group this vocabulary into logical categories:

i. Types of Animal Farming

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Livestock	A general term for domesticated animals	The farmer's livestock

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
	raised for profit or use, especially cattle, sheep, goats, and pigs.	included 50 cows and 100 goats.
Poultry	Domesticated birds (chickens, turkeys, ducks, geese) raised for their eggs or meat.	Poultry farming is profitable because of the high demand for eggs.
Piggery	The specific branch of farming focused on raising pigs or swine.	He built a clean piggery to prevent diseases.
Dairy	The branch of farming concerned with producing milk and milk products (like cheese and yoghurt).	Dairy cows must be milked twice a day.
Fishery	The farming of fish (aquaculture) or the industry of catching fish.	The coastal town's economy depends on its fishery .
Apiary	A place where bees are kept (in beehives) for their honey.	An apiary requires special knowledge of bee behaviour.

ii. Animal Housing and Location

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Pen	A small, fenced enclosure for keeping animals like goats, pigs, or sheep.	The goats are kept in a wooden pen behind the house.

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Coop	A small cage or house for poultry.	He cleaned the chicken coop every morning.
Stable	A building where horses are kept and fed.	The racehorse was resting in its stable .
Pasture	Land covered with grass and other plants, suitable for animals (especially cattle and sheep) to graze on.	The herdsman led the cows to the green pasture .
Paddock	A small field or enclosure, usually near a stable, where horses are kept.	The horses were running in the paddock .

iii. People and Animal Health

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Herdsman	A person who owns or takes care of a herd of livestock, usually cattle.	The herdsman guided the cattle with his long stick.
Shepherd	A person who takes care of sheep.	The shepherd and his dog protected the flock.
Vet (Veterinary Doctor)	An animal doctor who is trained to diagnose, treat, and prevent diseases in animals.	We called the vet when our dog became sick.

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Vaccination	Giving an animal a vaccine to prevent it from getting a specific disease.	Vaccination of the day-old chicks is compulsory.

iv. Processes and Feed

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Breeding	The process of causing animals to produce offspring (babies), often to develop specific qualities.	Selective breeding has produced cows that give more milk.
Grazing	The act of animals eating grass directly from a pasture.	Grazing is the most natural way to feed cattle.
Feed	Prepared food given to farm animals.	The farmer bought ten bags of poultry feed .
Fodder	Dried food, like hay or straw, used as animal feed.	They stored fodder in the barn for the dry season.
Incubator	A heated container used to hatch eggs artificially.	The incubator allows the farm to hatch 500 eggs at once.

4. Evaluation

1. Define "animal husbandry" in your own words.
2. What is the main difference between "poultry" and "piggery"?
3. Explain the roles of these two people: a **Herdsman** and a **Veterinary Doctor**.

4. Differentiate between "feed" and "pasture."
5. Use the following five words in correct sentences: **livestock, breeding, pen, vet, dairy.**

5. Assignment

1. Write a short paragraph (about 100 words) on the topic "My Visit to a Poultry Farm." You must use at least five (5) words from this lesson (e.g., *poultry, coop, feed, incubator, vaccination*).
 2. Create a table listing ten (10) new words you learned from this lesson, along with their meanings.
 3. In your community, what is the most common form of animal husbandry? Describe it in two sentences.
-

🔊 B. SPOKEN ENGLISH (ORAL ENGLISH)

Topic: Consonants Followed by /j/

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Identify the /j/ sound as the "y" glide (semi-vowel).
- Recognize consonant + /j/ clusters in English words.
- Understand the difference in pronunciation of these clusters in British (BrE) and American (AmE) English.
- Accurately pronounce words containing clusters like /kj/, /gj/, /tju/, /dju/, /nju/, /hju/.

2. Content: Introduction

In English pronunciation, the sound /j/ is not the letter 'j'. It is the **"y" sound** found at the beginning of the word **"yes"** /jes/. It is a **glide** or **semi-vowel**, where the tongue moves from a high-front position (like for /i:/) to the next vowel.

This /j/ sound often follows a consonant, creating a "consonant + y" blend.

- **Example:** music is not "moo-zik". It is /mju:zɪk/ ("myoo-zik").

3. Pronunciation and Regional Variation (Yod-Dropping)

A major difference between British English (BrE) and American English (AmE) involves this /j/ sound. This is called "**yod-dropping**".

- **BrE (and standard Nigerian English):** Tends to *keep* the /j/ sound.
- **AmE:** Tends to *drop* the /j/ sound after /t/, /d/, and /n/.

Let's look at the clusters:

Cluster	Example Words	Phonetic Transcription (BrE)	Pronunciation Guide (AmE note)
/pj/	pure, pupil, computer	/'pjʊə/, /'pjʊ:pɪl/, /kəm'pjʊ:tə/	(Pronounced the same in AmE)
/bj/	beauty, bureau, beautiful	/'bjʊ:ti/, /'bjʊərəʊ/, /'bjʊ:tɪfəl/	(Pronounced the same in AmE)
/kj/	cure, curious, cute	/kjʊə/, /'kjʊəriəs/, /kju:t/	(Pronounced the same in AmE)
/mj/	music, mute, amuse	/'mju:zɪk/, /mju:t/, /ə'mju:z/	(Pronounced the same in AmE)
/fj/	few, fuel, fume, feud	/fju:/, /fju:əl/, /fju:m/, /fju:d/	(Pronounced the same in AmE)

Cluster	Example Words	Phonetic Transcription (BrE)	Pronunciation Guide (AmE note)
/vj/	view, review, interview	/vju:/, /rɪ'vju:/, /'ɪntəvju:/	(Pronounced the same in AmE)
/hju/	huge, human, humour, humid	/hju:dʒ/, /'hju:mən/, /'hju:mə/	(Pronounced the same in AmE)
/tju/	Tuesday , tune , student , tube	/'tju:zdeɪ/, /tju:n/, /'stju:dənt/	(Yod-Dropping: AmE says /'tu:zdeɪ/, /tu:n/, /'stu:dənt/)
/dju/	due , duty , endure , durable	/dju:/, /'dju:ti/, /ɪn'dʒʊə/	(Yod-Dropping: AmE says /du:/, /'du:ti/, /ɪn'dʊər/)
/nju/	new , neutral , nuclear , nude	/nju:/, /'nju:trəl/, /'nju:klɪə/	(Yod-Dropping: AmE says /nu:/, /'nu:trəl/, /'nu:klɪər/)

4. Practice Drills

Repeat these words after your teacher, focusing on the /j/ glide (the "y" sound).

- **Column 1 (Clear /j/):**
 - music / beauty / pure / cure / few / view / huge
- **Column 2 (BrE /j/):**
 - Tuesday / student / new / duty / endure / tune

Sentence Drills (Practice with BrE pronunciation):

1. The **new student** had a **huge** sense of **humour**.
2. It is his **duty** to play **music** every **Tuesday**.

3. The **beautiful view** was a **cure** for his bad mood.
4. Are you **curious** about the **new computer**?

5. Evaluation

1. What common English letter sound does the phonetic symbol /j/ represent?
2. What is "yod-dropping"? Which variety of English is it most associated with?
3. Pronounce the following words clearly for your teacher:
 - (a) new (b) student (c) music (d) huge (e) view
4. Write the phonetic transcription for:
 - (a) beauty (b) cure
5. Write three sentences of your own, each using at least two words from the lesson.

6. Assignment

1. Find and write ten (10) English words (not from the lesson) that have a consonant + /j/ cluster.
 2. Write the phonetic transcription for each of your ten words (you may use a dictionary to help).
 3. Use five (5) of your new words in meaningful sentences.
-

4 C. CONTINUOUS WRITING

Topic: Descriptive Composition – "A Fire Incident in My Street"

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Understand the purpose of a descriptive composition.
- Use a "Sensory Bank" to gather details before writing.
- Employ vivid adjectives, adverbs, and strong verbs.

- Use figurative language (similes, metaphors, personification) to make the description powerful.
- Organize a description in a logical order (e.g., chronological).
- Write an engaging essay describing a fire incident.

2. Content: Introduction

A **descriptive composition** aims to "paint a picture with words." Your goal is to make your reader feel like they are *at the scene*. You must appeal to their **five senses**. A fire incident is a powerful topic because it is full of intense sensations.

This is different from a narrative.

- **Narrative:** Tells the *story* of the fire (e.g., "First, it started, *then* the firemen came, *finally* it was over.")
- **Descriptive:** Focuses on the *experience* of the fire (e.g., "The heat was scorching, the smoke was choking, and the sounds were terrifying.")

3. Pre-Writing: The Sensory Bank

A good description starts with observation. Let's brainstorm words for a fire scene:

Sense	Sensory Details
Sight 👁	Thick, black, billowing smoke; angry, orange/red flames; glowing embers; firefighters' blue/red flashing lights; terrified faces; people running; cracked walls; shattered glass; a "skeleton" of the burnt building.
Sound 🗣	Loud screams, "Help!", "Fire!"; the <i>crackling</i> and <i>popping</i> of burning wood; <i>shattering</i> glass; the <i>roar</i> of the fire; the <i>wail</i> of sirens; the <i>shouts</i> of firefighters; bitter weeping.

Sense	Sensory Details
Smell 🦂	Acrid smoke; the <i>stench</i> of burning plastic/rubber; scorched wood; singed hair; sulphur; a <i>choking</i> smell that burns the nostrils.
Touch/Feeling 🖐️	Intense, unbearable heat; stinging smoke in the eyes; hot tears; the <i>spray</i> of the fire hose; the <i>push</i> of the panicked crowd; a <i>pounding</i> heart.
Dominant Mood	Panic, Chaos, Fear, Despair, Sadness, Shock

4. Using Figurative Language

This makes your description memorable.

- **Simile (like/as):** "The smoke rose *like* a dark giant." / "The flames danced *like* angry spears."
- **Metaphor (is/are):** "The fire *was* a raging monster." / "The building *was* a burning skeleton."
- **Personification (giving human traits):** "The fire *devoured* the house." / "Flames *licked* at the windows." / "The siren *screamed*."

5. Sample Composition (Expanded)

Title: The Day the Street Burned

It was a hot, dry Sunday afternoon, and the air was still. Suddenly, the peace was **shattered** by a woman's high-pitched scream: "Fire! Fire!" I ran outside and froze. Thick, **black smoke** was **billowing** into the sky from Mr. Kalu's shop, just three houses down. The smoke **was a dark monster**, blocking out the sun.

Within minutes, the scene descended into **chaos**. People ran in panic, some carrying children, others holding useless buckets of water. Then we saw the flames. They were not small; they were **angry, orange tongues** that **licked** greedily at the sky. The **heat** was intense, even from my spot,

and it pushed us back. We heard the **terrifying crackle** of the fire as it **devoured** the building's wooden roof, followed by the **shattering** of glass as the windows exploded.

The **stench** was unbearable—a **choking** mix of burning plastic and scorched wood. Women were crying, and men were shouting uselessly. When the fire engine's **siren wailed** in the distance, it was the most beautiful sound I had ever heard. Firefighters arrived and began battling the **raging beast** with powerful jets of water. After what felt like an eternity, the fire was put out, leaving behind the **blackened, skeletal ruins** of what used to be a home. Though no one died, the street was silent, shocked by the speed of the destruction.

6. Evaluation

1. What is the main goal of a descriptive composition?
2. List the five senses a writer should appeal to.
3. From the "Sensory Bank," list one detail for *Sight* and one for *Smell*.
4. What is the difference between a simile and personification? Give one example of each from the lesson.
5. What *mood* does the sample essay create?

7. Assignment

1. Write a descriptive essay (about 250-300 words) on the topic: "**A Market Fire I Witnessed.**" (If you have not witnessed one, imagine you did).
2. Focus on using details from all five senses.
3. Underline at least two (2) examples of figurative language (simile, metaphor, or personification) that you use.
4. State three safety measures that can help prevent fire outbreaks in a market or home.

D. GRAMMAR

Topic: Irregular Verbs

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define irregular verbs and contrast them with regular verbs.
- Identify the common patterns of irregular verbs.
- State the Base Form, Past Tense, and Past Participle of common irregular verbs.
- Use irregular verbs correctly in sentences, especially distinguishing between the Past Tense and Past Participle.

2. Content: Introduction

In English, we change verbs to show tense (past, present, future).

- **Regular Verbs** are easy. They follow a fixed rule: add **-d** or **-ed** to form the past tense and past participle.
 - walk → walked → walked
 - love → loved → loved
- **Irregular Verbs** are the "rebels" of English. They do not follow this rule. Their past tense and past participle forms change in unpredictable ways. They are remnants of Old English and must be memorized.

Forms:

- **Base Form:** The verb in its infinitive form (e.g., to eat).
- **Past Tense:** Used for actions completed in the past (e.g., "I ate yesterday.").
- **Past Participle:** Used with auxiliary verbs (has, have, had, was, were) to form perfect and passive tenses (e.g., "I have eaten." or "It was eaten.").

3. Common Groups of Irregular Verbs

Memorizing them in groups makes it easier.

Group 1: No Change (All three forms are the same)

Base	Past Tense	Past Participle
cut	cut	cut
put	put	put
shut	shut	shut
hit	hit	hit
cost	cost	cost
spread	spread	spread

Group 2: Vowel Change (Past & Past Participle are the same)

Base	Past Tense	Past Participle
bring	brought	brought
buy	bought	bought
catch	caught	caught
feel	felt	felt
get	got	got (or gotten in AmE)

Base	Past Tense	Past Participle
keep	kept	kept
leave	left	left
sell	sold	sold
teach	taught	taught

Group 3: Vowel Change (All three forms are different)

Base	Past Tense	Past Participle
begin	began	begun
drink	drank	drunk
sing	sang	sung
swim	swam	swum
ring	rang	rung

Group 4: Past Participle adds '-en'

Base	Past Tense	Past Participle
break	broke	broken

Base	Past Tense	Past Participle
choose	chose	chosen
eat	ate	eaten
give	gave	given
see	saw	seen
speak	spoke	spoken
steal	stole	stolen
take	took	taken
write	wrote	written
drive	drove	driven

Group 5: The Most Irregular

Base	Past Tense	Past Participle
be (am/is/are)	was/were	been
go	went	gone
do	did	done

4. Evaluation

1. What is the main difference between a regular verb and an irregular verb?
2. Give two examples of irregular verbs where all three forms (Base, Past, Past Participle) are the same.
3. Fill in the blanks with the *correct* form of the verb in parentheses. This is the most common mistake:
 - **Past Tense:** "I _____ (go) to the market yesterday."
 - **Past Participle:** "I have _____ (go) to the market already."
4. Complete the table:

Verb	Past Tense	Past Participle
Speak		
eat		
(c)	began	begun
(d)		cut
drink		

5. Assignment

1. Write ten (10) irregular verbs (not from the evaluation) with their Base, Past Tense, and Past Participle forms.
2. Write five (5) sentences. In each sentence, you must use the **Past Participle** form of an irregular verb (e.g., "The glass was **broken** by the wind." "She has **written** the letter.").

3. Write a short paragraph (about 5-6 lines) describing something you did last weekend. You must use at least five (5) different **Past Tense** irregular verbs (e.g., "*I went to...*", "*I saw...*", "*We ate...*"). Underline them.



WEEK 12

🔊 1. SPOKEN ENGLISH (ORAL ENGLISH)

Topic: Consonants Followed by /j/ and the Vowel /u:/

(a) Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Identify the /j/ sound (as in "yes") and the /u:/ sound (as in "food").
- Describe the production of both sounds (tongue and lip positions).
- Accurately pronounce consonant clusters that include the /j/ sound (e.g., /kj/, /nj/, /tju:/).
- Differentiate between the long vowel /u:/ and the short vowel /ʊ/ (as in "pull").
- Understand the concept of "yod-dropping" in different accents of English.

(b) The /j/ Sound (Palatal Approximant)

The /j/ sound is **not** the letter 'j'. It is the sound of the letter 'y' in "yes" /jes/. It is a semi-vowel, or "glide," produced by raising the front/middle of the tongue high towards the hard palate, but not close enough to cause friction.

When this /j/ sound follows a consonant, it creates a blend.

Cluster	Example Words	Phonetic Transcription	Pronunciation Guide
/kj/	cue, curious, cure, accuse	/kju:/, /'kjʊəriəs/, /kjʊə/, /ə'kju:z/	"kyoo"
/gj/	argue, regular, figure	/'ɑ:gju:/, /'regjʊlə/, /'figjə/	"gyoo"

Cluster	Example Words	Phonetic Transcription	Pronunciation Guide
/mj/	amuse, music, mute	/ə'mju:z/, /'mju:zɪk/, /mju:t/	"myoo"
/nj/	new, news, tune, menu	/nju:./, /nju:z/, /tju:n/, /'menju:./	"nyoo"
/pj/	pure, pupil, computer	/pjʊə/, /'pju:pɪl/, /kəm'pjʊ:tə/	"pyoo"
/bj/	beauty, beautiful	/'bju:ti/, /'bju:tɪfəl/	"byoo"
/fj/	few, fume, furious	/fju:./, /fju:m/, /'fjʊəriəs/	"fyoo"
/vj/	view, review	/vju:./, /rɪ'vju:./	"vyoo"

(c) Understanding "Yod-Dropping" (Accent Variation)

The /j/ sound is sometimes called the "yod." In some accents, this "yod" is dropped, especially in American English (AmE).

- **British English (BrE) / Standard Nigerian English:** Tends to *keep* the /j/ sound.
- **American English (AmE):** Tends to *drop* the /j/ sound after /t/, /d/, and /n/.

Compare:

- **tune:** BrE /tju:n/ (tyoon) | AmE /tu:n/ (toon)
- **due:** BrE /dju:./ (dyoo) | AmE /du:./ (doo)
- **new:** BrE /nju:./ (nyoo) | AmE /nu:./ (noo)

For your examinations (WAEC/NECO), you are expected to know and use the **British (BrE) pronunciation**, which *includes* the /j/ sound.

(d) The /u:/ Sound (Long Close Back Vowel)

This is the long "oo" sound.

- **How to Produce:** The back of the tongue is high, and the lips are rounded tightly.
- **Examples:** food, blue, true, school, fruit, rule, June, move, group.

Crucial Minimal Pairs: /u:/ (long) vs. /ʊ/ (short)

This is a very common test area. The /ʊ/ sound (as in "pull") has less rounded lips and is much shorter.

/u:/ (long "oo")	/ʊ/ (short "u")
pool	pull
fool	full
Luke	look
shoed	should
boot	book

(e) Combining /j/ and /u:/

Many words from section (b) combine these two sounds.

- **due** = /d/ + /j/ + /u:/ → /dju:/
- **stew** = /s/ + /t/ + /j/ + /u:/ → /stju:/
- **new** = /n/ + /j/ + /u:/ → /nju:/
- **music** = /m/ + /j/ + /u:/ + /zɪk/ → /'mju:zɪk/

(f) EVALUATION (Spoken English)

1. Pronounce the following words clearly for your teacher:
 - (a) cue (b) new (c) due (d) food (e) pull (f) curious
2. Write two word-examples for each of these clusters: /kj/, /nj/, /fj/.
3. What is the main difference in production between the /u:/ sound and the /ʊ/ sound?
4. Transcribe the following words in phonetic symbols: (a) due, (b) blue, (c) music.
5. What is "yod-dropping," and which pronunciation (with or without yod) is standard for /tʃ/ in Nigerian English?

(g) ASSIGNMENT (Spoken English)

1. Write ten (10) words that contain the /j/ sound after a consonant.
2. Write ten (10) words that contain the long /u:/ sound.
3. Write five minimal pairs to contrast /u:/ and /ʊ/. (Do not use more than two from the lesson).

🎧 2. LISTENING COMPREHENSION

Topic: Listening to a Short Debate

(a) Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define what a debate is and identify its key components (motion, proposition, opposition).

- Listen to identify the main arguments of each speaker.
- Differentiate between a main argument and its supporting evidence.
- Identify signal words used for persuasion and structure.

(b) Introduction

A **debate** is a formal, structured argument between two sides on a specific topic, called a "**motion**."

- The **Proposition** (or "For") side agrees with the motion.
- The **Opposition** (or "Against") side disagrees with the motion.

Your job as a listener is not to be persuaded, but to be an *analyst*. You must listen carefully to *what* each side says and *how* they say it.

(c) Listening Skills to Apply

- **Focus on Main Arguments:** Don't get lost in small details. What is the speaker's *main reason*?
- **Listen for Supporting Evidence:** How do they support that reason? Do they use *facts*, *statistics*, *examples*, or just *emotion*?
- **Listen for Signal Words (Signposts):**
 - *To introduce points:* "My first point is...", "Secondly...", "Furthermore..."
 - *To disagree:* "My opponent said...", "However...", "On the contrary..."
 - *To conclude:* "In conclusion...", "Therefore...", "I urge you to see..."
- **Note-Taking:** Use a T-Chart to organize your notes.

FOR	AGAINST
Point 1:	Point 1:
Point 2:	Point 2:

(d) Class Activity: Listening to a Debate

Your teacher (or a recording) will present the following short debate. Listen carefully.

Motion: "Television does more harm than good to students."

Speaker A (Proposition / FOR):

"Good morning. The motion is clear: television does more harm than good, and I strongly agree. My first point is that television is a major cause of poor academic performance. It is addictive. Students spend hours watching movies and music videos instead of reading their books or doing their homework. Secondly, television exposes children to violence and values that are not part of our culture. They see crime and bad behaviour and think it is normal. In conclusion, television is a dangerous distraction that harms our students."

Speaker B (Opposition / AGAINST):

"My opponent has painted a very one-sided picture. On the contrary, television is one of the most powerful tools for education. Where else can a student watch live documentaries about wildlife in the Amazon, or see the inside of a volcano? Furthermore, television connects us to the world. We learn about global events and politics from news channels. It provides information and relaxation. The problem is not the television; the problem is a lack of discipline and parental guidance. Therefore, I urge you to reject this motion."

(e) EVALUATION (Listening Comprehension)

1. What was the motion (topic) of the debate you just listened to?
2. State one main argument from Speaker A (For) and one main argument from Speaker B (Against).
3. What supporting example did Speaker B use to prove that television is educational?
4. Speaker A used the signal words "My first point..." and "Secondly...". What signal words did Speaker B use to show (a) disagreement and (b) an additional point?
5. Based *only* on the arguments, which speaker do you think was more persuasive, and why?

(f) ASSIGNMENT (Listening Comprehension)

1. Listen to a real debate or a discussion program on the radio or TV (e.g., *Channels TV's "Politics Today"* or a similar program).
 2. Write down the topic being discussed.
 3. Summarize the main argument of one person and the main argument of another person who disagrees.
 4. Write down two (2) signal words or persuasive phrases you heard them use.
-

☐ 3. READING COMPREHENSION

Topic: Identifying Main Ideas

(a) Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define "main idea" in a reading passage.
- Differentiate between the *topic*, the *main idea*, and *supporting details*.
- Locate the "topic sentence" which often states the main idea.
- Summarize the central point of a passage in one concise sentence.

(b) Introduction

When you read a passage, the author has one central message they want you to understand. This is the **main idea**. It's the "big picture," the main reason the author wrote the passage.

- **Topic:** What the passage is about (1-2 words).
- **Main Idea:** The *most important point* the author makes *about* the topic (a full sentence).
- **Supporting Details:** The facts, examples, and reasons that *prove* or *explain* the main idea.

How to Find the Main Idea:

1. **Read the title and skim the passage:** What is the *topic*?
2. **Read the paragraph(s) carefully:** Look for the **topic sentence**. This is the one sentence that seems to summarize the entire paragraph. It is often the *first* or *last* sentence.
3. **Look for repeated words or concepts:** These give clues to the main idea.
4. **Ask yourself:** "What is the *one thing* the author wants me to know about [the topic]?"

(c) Example Passage (From user)

Nigeria is blessed with many natural resources such as crude oil, coal, and limestone. However, corruption and mismanagement have prevented the nation from fully benefiting from these resources. If citizens show honesty and accountability, the country's economy will improve greatly.

- **Topic:** Nigeria's Resources and Economy.
- **Supporting Detail:** Nigeria has crude oil, coal, and limestone.
- **Supporting Detail:** Citizens should show honesty.
- **Main Idea:** (What is the one central point?) **Nigeria's economic problem is not a lack of resources, but a lack of good management due to corruption.**

(d) Practice Passage

Social media has fundamentally changed how we communicate. Platforms like Instagram, X (formerly Twitter), and TikTok allow for instant connection with people across the world. They can be powerful tools for business, education, and social movements. However, this constant connection has a downside. Studies have shown that excessive social media use can lead to anxiety, depression, and poor sleep patterns. It can also spread misinformation at a very fast rate. Therefore, users must be mindful and learn to balance their online and offline lives.

- **Topic:** Social Media.
- **Main Idea:** (What is the author's main point about social media?)
 - ... (Answer: Social media is a powerful tool with both significant benefits and serious dangers, so users must be careful.)

(e) EVALUATION (Reading Comprehension)

(Based on the *Practice Passage* about Social Media)

1. What is the main idea of the passage? (Summarize it in one sentence).
2. What is the *topic* of the passage?
3. Mention two *positive* effects (supporting details) of social media listed.
4. Mention two *negative* effects (supporting details) listed.
5. What solution or advice does the author give in the last sentence?

(f) ASSIGNMENT (Reading Comprehension)

1. Find and read a short editorial or article from a newspaper (or a reputable online source).
 2. Paste or copy the article into your notebook.
 3. Below the article, write:
 - (a) A suitable title for the article (if it doesn't have one).
 - (b) The Topic: (in 1-3 words)
 - (c) The Main Idea: (in one complete sentence)
 - (d) Two (2) supporting details from the article.
-

4. GRAMMAR

Topic: Irregular Verbs (Continued)

(a) Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Recall the definition of an irregular verb.
- Differentiate between the **Past Tense** form and the **Past Participle** form.

- Identify the correct usage of Past Participles with auxiliary verbs (has, have, had, was, were).
- Memorize and use a new set of common irregular verbs.

(b) Introduction

A regular verb forms its past tense by adding -ed (walk $\rightarrow$ walked).

An irregular verb does not follow this rule. It changes its form, often by changing its vowel.

The Three Key Forms:

1. **Base Form (Present):** The basic verb (e.g., eat, go, see).
2. **Past Tense:** Used for a completed action in the past. It *stands alone*.
 - "I **went** to the market yesterday."
3. **Past Participle:** Used with a "helper" (auxiliary) verb (e.g., *has, have, had, was, were*).
 - "I have **gone** to the market."
 - "The food was **eaten**."

The Most Common Error: Using the Past Tense form when you should use the Past Participle.

- **Wrong:** "She has *wrote* the letter."
- **Correct:** "She has **written** the letter."
- **Wrong:** "The glass was *broke*."
- **Correct:** "The glass was **broken**."

(c) Common Irregular Verbs (Grouped)

Grouping them by pattern makes them easier to learn.

Group 1: All Three Forms are Different (i $\rightarrow$ a $\rightarrow$ u)

Base	Past Tense	Past Participle
begin	began	begun
drink	drank	drunk
sing	sang	sung
swim	swam	swum

ring	rang	rung
------	------	------

Group 2: Past Participle Ends in “-en”

Base	Past Tense	Past Participle
break	broke	broken
choose	chose	chosen
eat	ate	eaten
fall	fell	fallen
give	gave	given
see	saw	seen
speak	spoke	spoken
take	took	taken
write	wrote	written

Group 3: Past and Past Participle Are the Same

Base	Past Tense	Past Participle
buy	bought	bought
catch	caught	caught
bring	brought	brought
feel	felt	felt
keep	kept	kept
leave	left	left
sell	sold	sold
teach	taught	taught

(d) EVALUATION (Grammar)

1. Define an irregular verb in your own words.
2. What is the main difference between the *Past Tense* and the *Past Participle* in terms of how they are used in a sentence?
3. Complete the following sentences with the correct form of the verb in brackets.
 - (a) She has _____ (begin) to read the book.
 - (b) The boy _____ (run) home from school yesterday.
 - (c) We _____ (see) that movie last week.
 - (d) The song was _____ (sing) by the choir.

- (e) I have _____ (eat) all my food.
- 4. Write the Past Tense and Past Participle forms for: **go, write, drink, speak, take.**

(e) ASSIGNMENT (Grammar)

1. List ten (10) irregular verbs that were *not* in today's lesson (e.g., fly, know, grow, etc.). Write their Past Tense and Past Participle forms.
2. Write five (5) original sentences that *correctly* use the **Past Participle** form with a helper verb. (e.g., "The window was *broken* by the ball.")
3. Write a short paragraph (3-5 sentences) about something you did last weekend. You must use at least five **Past Tense** irregular verbs. Underline them.

